

TAN BRICK HOUSE

Written by  
Justin Del Vecchio

June 2026

INT. COFFEE SHOP - MORNING

MIKA BOYKO, early 60s, with a Ukrainian accent, waits in line.

The customer ahead of him stares at his phone.

The CASHIER extends a handful of change and waits for the customer.

MIKA

Ahem.

CUSTOMER

Oh hey, thanks! Thanks!

The CUSTOMER collects his change and moves along.

Mika places two dollars, one quarter, and two pennies on the counter.

MIKA

Hi, usual.

MIKA takes coffee, finds table and sits with multiple friends.

Older, clearly retirees.

FRIEND 1

Hey Mika, how are you doing?

MIKA

OK. Got up early, watched the sunrise, and walked here. Traffic is ridiculous today. Crazy. People speed like mad right by the school.

FRIEND 2

Hey, how's that house you gotta sell?

MIKA

I knew you would bring it up. Knew it. It has been three months now and nothing. Nothing.

Friend 1 smiles.

FRIEND 1

Seems longer than that!

Mika rubs his face.

MIKA

It is not. It is just three months.

Friend 3, at a table across the room, peers over the paper he's reading.

FRIEND 3

What house? What's that?

FRIEND 2

Oh, come on, man. Do you even listen to what we talk about? The house. The house!

FRIEND 3

I've been in Florida for three months!

Mika holds up both hands as if to say everything is OK.

MIKA

I will explain. The house. What is the house? OK. The house is my wife's parents'. Wonderful people. You hear stories about mothers-in-law and the troubles they manufacture. She would do anything for you. No trouble at all. Quiet. Beautiful.

FRIEND 2

I'm really going to have to listen to this all over again. I need another cup.

Friend 2 stands and walks away.

Mika sips his coffee.

MIKA

She would do anything for us. Her husband, he died back in the 90s. Smoked like you would not believe. He was nice, too, mind you. Just the smoking. The mother, she died in February.

FRIEND 3

Sorry about that.

MIKA

Yeah, yeah. Thanks. So ... we get the house. Nona has one sister. Stella. She lives in Austin and she tells Nona 'You sell the house. Keep the money. I lived in Austin for last 22 years - you took care of momma all that time. You should have it.' The sister, she got some  
(MORE)

MIKA (CONT'D)

money from the mother and did not, mind you, did not have to clean out all the shit from house. That was us for four weeks.

FRIEND 2

You got a house my friend! Easy money.

Friend 3 says in passing while going back to reading the paper.

FRIEND 3

Austin ...

MIKA

Yeah, easy money. And Austin is OK place. Visited my sister-in-law there four or five times. Visited twice in July. Crazy. Hot, hot, hot. You cannot leave the house in daytime, could only leave at night. Reminded me of Egypt where people in the summer only go outside at night.

Mika pauses for more coffee.

MIKA

The coffee is weak today. Who made this! OK, so, that is all good. All fine. Sister OK with everything. Wife OK with everything. All we need to do is sell the house, get the money, move on.

FLASHBACK:

INT. KITCHEN - MORNING

An aging Tudor home's kitchen.

MIKA sits at the table with his wife, NONA, beautiful and impeccably dressed.

She eats a Sausage McMuffin.

MIKA

All we have to do is sell the house. Put it on the market. Set a reasonable price, I know what that price is, and we are good.

Nona says somewhat irritated.

NONA  
I know. I know!

Nona then contemplates while holding the McMuffin.

NONA  
We can sell the house and then, we  
can think about a condo in Ft.  
Lauderdale.

MIKA  
I keep telling you - there is no way  
we can get anything good in Ft.  
Lauderdale for the price we can get  
for this house. No way. It's not  
like this house is equivalent to an  
ocean front in Ft. Lauderdale.

Nona finishes the McMuffin.

NONA  
You keep saying that. But you are  
not looking hard enough. I see these  
shows. I see the Beachfront  
Bargains, they find these things all  
the time. I will find something,  
let me look.

MIKA  
You can look all you want. All you  
want. I will not stop you from  
doing that. Download the app,  
search Ft. Lauderdale. There is  
nothing to be had for \$200 thousand  
that gets what I know you want. Not  
even close. It's just ... it's not  
even realistic Nona!

NONA  
Exactly, because you do not let me  
look. You are not looking right.

Mika shakes head, exhales, and looks away.

MIKA  
Let's just sell this thing first.  
Please. Let's do that. The house  
is empty now. Can we finally sell  
it. Then we can argue about Ft.  
Lauderdale.

NONA  
Yes, let's talk about the house. I  
know exactly what we need to do.

MIKA  
Good, good. Consensus. I know too.

NONA

Really, you know what to do. You have read my mind and know. Really.

MIKA

Yes, I have. I have looked at the prices. Houses, comparables.

Nona shaking head

NONA

Comparables.

MIKA

Yes. Yes. We should put a good price on the house. Go 240 K or 245 K to start and get offers. Move it out.

NONA

Really. That is what we should do.

MIKA

Yes. Really.

Nona smiles confidently.

NONA

This is what we are going to do.

Mika senses what is about to happen.

MIKA

No ... no.

NONA

We are going to use Mikey Derogai.

MIKA

No, no. Why. No. Why? Why Mikey?

NONA

Because, he is a real estate agent. He knows how to sell a house. And he knows how to get the best price. And we know his family.

Mika's English is good but at times, grammatically incorrect when agitated. There is certainly a Slavic accent though not that strong.

MIKA

Oh great! Great. So you are providing precise reasons we should not go with Mikey. What if things go wrong?

NONA

What do you mean, wrong?

MIKA

Mikey is not able to sell the house, he listens to you and prices it way too high, and he get exactly no one interested in looking at the house. I know this kid, we know this kid, we know exactly what he is capable of.

NONA

He sold Mira's house. Two weeks. Two weeks and the house was sold. We will have no problems. None.

MIKA

Oh come on. Mira's house was perfect. Perfect. Updated kitchen, huge yard, you could fit three cars in that garage. I could have sold that house. Easy to do. Your parent's house, this house, not easy.

Nona smiles confidently again after a sip of coffee.

NONA

No. No. This house is perfect. It is great. There will be no problems.

MIKA

It is not great. Not great. Not not great. It's good, it's a good house, yes. But it has problems.

NONA

Like what?

MIKA

Like the fact the kitchen is out of a 1970s Reader's Digest advertisement. Like the fact there are three bathrooms with pink tiles. Pink tiles. Three. Like the fact every square inch of flooring that is not in the bathroom is carpeting from the 1980s.

NONA

You can stop now. I do not need to listen to this. This house -

She pauses to sip coffee

NONA  
This house, is perfect. It will  
sell. Besides, I have already  
called Mikey.

MIKA  
How? When? Why did you do this and  
not ask me?

Nona speaks perfect English with no accent.

NONA  
Um, because, I do not need your  
permission. It is my house. I make  
the decisions.

MIKA  
You do not need my permission that  
is not what I said.

NONA  
Sure sounded like it.

MIKA  
Not my permission, just my advice.

NONA  
There is some difference between the  
two?

MIKA  
Yes, of course. Of course there is.  
I would have told you 'Mikey, I  
don't think he is a good choice.' I  
see realtors online, I think I know  
which ones are good. We get that  
flyer from the Spencer woman, she  
seems like she knows how to sell a  
house.

Nona laughs.

NONA  
Well we meet Mikey tomorrow.

MIKA  
When?

NONA  
4 PM at my parent's house.

MIKA  
Opportunity to discuss?

NONA  
Nope. Do you want more coffee.



MIKA  
Please ... yes.

NONA  
Oh, it is two, by the way.

MIKA  
Two what?

NONA  
Two bathrooms with pink tile. The  
other is lime green.

EXT. TAN BRICK HOUSE - DAYTIME

A plain tan-brick house from the early '70s.

MIKA checks his watch: 4:20. Nearby, NONA admires the  
front garden.

A black four-door BMW with tinted windows pulls up. Vanity  
plate: DEROGAI.

MIKEY, 6'2", handsome, and sharply dressed in gray slacks  
and a trench coat, steps out. He sets his coffee on the  
roof, removes his sunglasses, grabs an attache case, and  
strides toward Mika.

MIKEY  
(booming, optimistic)  
Mika! Nona! It is so good to see  
you!

Mikey moves in for a hug.

A giddy Nona goes over for an embrace.

NONA  
Oh Mikey, we are so glad you can  
help! So great. How are you! How  
is everything!

MIKEY  
Oh Nona, it could not be better.  
Could not be better! Look!

Mikey gestures to BMW.

He goes to shake hands with Mika.

MIKA  
You are late. 20 minutes. Late.

MIKEY  
Ohhhh, so sorry. So sorry. I had  
to take get the kids from hockey  
(MORE)

MIKEY (CONT'D)  
practice. It went late. I wanted  
to call but I only had your home  
number and figured you would already  
be here.

MIKA  
And yet you have coffee.

Mikey walks beside Nona.

MIKEY  
Yeah, they sell it at the rink.  
What did we do here!

NONA  
Don't worry about being late. We  
have nothing to do. Look, I cleaned  
up the front of the house.

Mikey stops to look at entirety of the house.

MIKEY  
Oh every little bit helps Nona.  
Every little bit. This, this, this  
is a great house. Great house!

MIKA  
Yes, good house. Not great though.  
But good.

MIKEY  
No, no, do not undersell this house.  
This is a GREAT house.

Mikey makes a gesture with his hand as though taking a  
picture.

NONA.  
See! I keep telling him it is  
great, Mikey, but he will not  
listen. He will not listen.

MIKEY  
Don't worry Nona, we'll win him  
over.

Both start laughing.

MIKEY  
I already know the price for the  
house.

MIKA  
What? How the hell do you know the  
price for this house. You have not  
(MORE)

MIKA (CONT'D)

step foot in here, in, what 17 years? Again, how the hell do you know?

MIKEY

Mika. Mika! I know real estate! I know this stuff. I looked at the pictures on Google Maps. I know the exact price. Nona -

Mikey looks to Nona.

MIKEY

I know the exact price for this beautiful house, I know.

NONA

Oh Mikey, I know you do. I know you do. Come on, let's look at.

MIKA

Why bother? He knows the price. He doesn't need to look at anything. By the way, uh, what exactly is the price. The perfect price.

Mikey stands hands at hip.

Taking snapshot pose with hands once again he looks to Nona.

MIKEY

The price. The price is 320. 320 and not a nickle less.

NONA

Yes!

MIKA

Oh come on!

MIKEY

Absolutely. No doubt! The price is 320 and we can close this baby, smooth deal, in two weeks.

MIKA

You haven't even looked inside. Mikey, I am sorry. But you are crazy if you think you are gonna get 320 for this house it's - it -

Mikey interrupts.

MIKEY

Nona. Listen to this guy. Listen to him!

Mikey slaps Mika on the back a bit too hard.

MIKEY

The house will sell. For 320. I know real estate. I live and breathe this stuff. This house will sell for 320. No doubt.

NONA

I knew it. That will set us up for something special in Ft. Lauderdale.

MIKA

Its not going to sell for that. Never going to sell. And even if it did, 320 gets nothing special in Ft. Lauderdale for that amount. Sorry. Nothing.

Mika looks to Mikey.

MIKA

Please, set the price lower. Please at least look at it before you set the price.

MIKEY

Why go low when you can go high and get the price you want. The price you need!

MIKA

Mikey, house is not worth that amount. It should be 240 to 245 at most. At most. Make your life. God, make our life easy. Just start at a reasonable price, sell it fast and get it done.

Mikey simply laughs and shakes head.

MIKEY

Why 240 may I ask. Why that price?

MIKA

First, the interior is outdated. All the rooms, all the rooms need renovations. All, every last one. Have seen the popcorn ceilings in there? It's of a type never seen before - like Christmas ornaments.

MIKEY

Ahhhh.... but the house has a good layout. It has a great layout. You can't beat that. And a lot of people like that 70s stuff. Vintage. It is coming back.

MIKA

Again, you haven't been in this frigging house in 17 years. Why don't you walk through. Just imagine you are buyer. You have this mental calculator that figures out renos costs. 10, 20, 30, very quickly you get to 60, 80 thousand in renos to make house match the other houses in this neighborhood.

MIKEY

Exactly, it's a great neighborhood.

MIKA

Yeah, it is, it is. Have you looked at the comparables? Have you seen houses with this square footage? Look at how good they are on the interior. This is, a joke -

Mikey laughs.

MIKEY

Comparables. Nona, you did not tell me that Mika had a side hustle as a real estate agent. You should have told me!

NONA

Oh Mikey, let's go inside and look. The coffee maker is still there. Do you remember? The Bunn one. I made coffee and have Danish for you.

MIKA

I am not a fan of Danish.

NONA

Mikey is.

Mika turning attention back to Mikey.

He points as he says this.

MIKA

Mikey, I go two blocks that way and find houses with the same amount of space, less traffic, no updates  
(MORE)

MIKA (CONT'D)  
needed, they go for 2-9-9. Why the  
hell would this go for 320.

MIKEY  
You forget about the intangibles.

MIKA  
What? What? What intangibles?  
What, that is on high traffic street  
with crappy interior. Is on Main  
Street. Mikey, Main Street. Every  
town has a Main street. It is  
always one thing; busy.

MIKEY  
Exactly, benefit one. It's on Main  
Street.

MIKA  
So?

MIKEY  
Zoned residential.

Mikey turns to look at Nona and points to house.

MIKEY  
And commercial.

MIKA  
So!

MIKEY  
You just doubled your market my  
friend. Doubled it. It could work  
for a family or professional or  
doctor or lawyer -

MIKA  
Yes, because lawyers are so  
interested in doing home renovations  
and not in sending you \$300 invoice  
for a half hour of work spent on  
sending out letter that the will  
reading date has has been set.  
Yeah, they love renovations.

NONA  
Mika, please listen to Mikey.

MIKA  
What?

MIKEY  
Mika, Mika, lets look inside the  
(MORE)

MIKEY (CONT'D)

house. I am going to show how we  
are going to get 3-2-0 for this.

Group heads up driveway to front door.

Mikey opens door to house with interior clearly out of  
1971.

MIKEY

This house. This house! What a  
layout, just as I remembered it.  
People are going to love it.

MIKA

Or, or. They might just walk  
through this door and think first  
'This is a lot of work.'

Mikey disregards comment.

Sets coffee down and produces a camera.

He chats with Nona he then takes one pic.

He next heads to the kitchen and takes one pic, still  
chatting with Nona.

Mika proceeds to walk through the mostly empty house.

Peeks into outdated bathrooms and heavily wood paneled  
rumpus room with a massive, 1970s stereo player.

MIKEY

And whose bedroom was this?

NONA

Stella's. Stella. She had this  
wall covered with posters of bands,  
it was quite beautiful how she laid  
it out. She was always an artist.  
That's why she is Austin now.

MIKEY

Oh Austin, that's a place we might  
want to move to! The market there  
is so hot.

Mikey again takes one picture of the bedroom room and  
moves on.

Mika flustered announces to no one.

MIKA

One picture.

MIKEY

Hmmm?

MIKA

One pic. Each room you take one picture. Why not take more than that? You know, a selection to choose from. Different angles.

MIKEY

Again, I am a real estate agent. I know this stuff. One and done!

10 MINUTES LATER

INT. KITCHEN

Nona is at the kitchen table.

NONA

They are all signed. All papers are signed. You are our agent Mikey!

Mika is resigned.

He also sits at the kitchen table.

MIKA

OK. Great. Great!

MIKEY

Hey, where is the pool table? Is it still here? In the basement.

NONA

Yes, it's still there! We couldn't sell it during the estate sale. It goes with the house.

MIKEY

Oh, bonus. Hey, I'm going to play a game. I need a pic of the basement, too!

Mikey heads to the basement with Nona.

NONA

Look, these pictures I painted for Mothers Day when I was in the fourth grade. I need to take these before we sell the house!

Mika is now alone in the kitchen.

Mika says to no one.



MIKA  
Why not take more pictures.

INT. KITCHEN

In Mika and Nona's house.

MIKA sits At the kitchen table.

He has a laptop.

NONA constructs some type of complicated dessert.

MIKA  
Still no photos. I must call him.  
I've got to. Got to.

Nona measures and then mixes.

NONA  
Emmmm ... OK, OK. We will call him.  
You are so worried, it's annoying.  
He will sell the house.

MIKA  
I know. I know. He will sell ...  
just not sure when. What is his  
number?

NONA  
Just look on my phone! There, by  
the mixer.

Mika finds a phone the by mixer.

He scrolls until he finds it.

Mika looks to see a Cyrillic recipe on the counter.

Mika then punches in a number on his cell phone.

Mikey's voice is heard.

MIKEY  
This is Mikey Derogai - the guy to  
sell your house! How may I help  
you.

MIKA  
Mikey

MIKEY  
Yes.

MIKA  
Mikey.

MIKEY

Yes this is he, who is this?

MIKA

Mika. Nona. It's us, the house you are selling.

MIKEY

Oh, Mika, Nona! How are you! What number is this, I've not seen it before.

MIKA

Is my cell phone.

MIKEY

You are officially in my contacts buddy! Any calls on the house yet, anything?

MIKA

Mikey, why would people be calling us? You are the real estate agent.

MIKEY

Well sometimes if they know the person selling, they call them and then you have to -

MIKA

Look, no one has called. And really - why would they - there is not a single picture of the house.

MIKEY

What?

MIKA

On the site, the site, there's no pictures. None.

MIKEY

What? What?

MIKA

The HOUSE. The Realtors Plus site. There is not one frigging picture of the house. Not one. Three days Mikey.

Nona looks condescendingly.

He waves her off.

She is back to measuring for a complicated dessert recipe.

NONA

Liters to ounces, what the fuck.  
Why don't I know this!

MIKEY

Ohhhhh .... ohhhhh ... lemme check.

MIKA

See Mikey, you don't have to check.  
I do that for you. There are no  
pictures.

MIKEY

Ohhhh ... yeah ... this part. Ummm  
... give it 10 minutes and check.  
The pics look great. Hey, is Nona  
there?

NONA

Hi Mikey! How many liters to the  
ounce.

MIKEY

Let me check my phone -

10 MINUTES LATER

Mika now sits at the table.

Mika is reading a book on small engine repair.

Nona is crouching and looking into an oven.

NONA

It's in. 60 minutes.

MIKA

At least there is no conversion on  
that, eh?

NONA

There is, centigrade to Fahrenheit.  
It's an easy one though.

Mikey pauses from reading.

Looks at screen of laptop.

MIKA

OK, OK. They are there. And they  
...

Pauses again.

MIKA

God dam it. God dam it!

NONA  
What? What now!

MIKA  
Come. Come. Come look. Witness it.

She turns from the coffee maker.

She was making a pot.

Mika is smiling.

MIKA  
Blurry. All are blurry.

NONA  
What?

Nona comes closer to look.

MIKA  
You don't have your frigging  
readers. Trust me, every picture is  
blurry. Every one. Every. How did  
he did he do it. Not one, not two.  
All! How.

Nona is back to the coffee.

NONA  
Something is wrong with the  
computer.

MIKA  
Oh yeah, uh-huh. Something is wrong  
the computer. Yeah. OK.

NONA  
OK, something is wrong his camera  
then. We need to tell Mikey.  
Honestly ...

MIKA  
Oh yes, his camera is broken. Sure.  
Is broke. Uh-huh. Calling him -

Mika is back to dialing the number.

MIKEY  
This is Mikey Derogai. The guy to  
sell your house. How can I help  
you!

MIKA  
By not having blurry pictures.

MIKEY

What, who is this?

MIKA

Mika, Nona. Hello! Pictures are blurry!

MIKEY

What pictures?

MIKA

Of the house! The house. All of the picture, except amazingly of the basement, are blurry. So if someone is interested in a pool table, dry basement, and rafters they are going to be very happy. Probably lay out a bid on the spot.

Nona reads a magazine at the kitchen counter.

She shouts.

NONA

Mikey, something must be wrong with your camera!

MIKEY

Oh hi Nona! Yeah, OK, let me look at this.

MIKA

Why look, you said they looked great. Have someone else look. You said the pictures looked great.

MIKEY

Um ... um .... uh give me five minutes.

FIVE MINUTES LATER

Both Nona and Mika sit at kitchen table in silence drinking coffee.

Nona happily pages through magazine.

NONA

They are doing a production on women's voting rights. That seems interesting!

MIKA

Yeah, what -

Nona's phone rings.

She answers and places into speaker mode.

MIKEY

Nona it's Mikey, the pictures are not good.

MIKA

That we know. That we are aware of.

MIKEY

I don't know why. It's that camera. That camera. They looked amazing in screen on the camera -

MIKA

Who cares. When can we take more. Is nice day, we can do it today or tomorrow.

MIKEY

Well, it will have to be Monday.

MIKA

It's frigging Thursday Mikey! Thursday.

MIKEY

Well, I am not in Aurora.

MIKA

Where the hell are you, Saigon?

MIKEY

No, Cleveland.

MIKA

Cleveland?

NONA

Cleveland! Oh, we have many relatives there Mikey, I can tell you where to go!

MIKEY

Oh, thanks Nona!

MIKA

Why the hell are you in Cleveland. That's like 4 hours away.

MIKEY

Oh, I'm taking the kids to a hockey tournament. Ryan has a tournament and I am taking Amber and Fisher too. It's something!

NONA

Oh, Mikey that sounds like fun! I always liked going on the trips with the kids.

MIKEY

You would think it would be but you spend so much time traveling, and in the hotel, and at the tournament. But, but the hotel has a pool on the 12th floor so the kids love that. And then -

Mika interrupts.

MIKA

Yes, great, Cleveland. What about the pictures. When!

MIKEY

Well, Monday. Or maybe today or tomorrow. I would have to call someone at the office. I think maybe Elly could do it. Yeah, that could work. Do you want me to call Elly?

MIKA

Mikey, that is good idea. That, is an actually good idea.

Nona looks disparagingly.

She shakes head at him.

MIKEY

Hey Fisher. Stop. STOP. Hey you have to stop that. Come on, now! Nona, Mikey, let me - Fisher give it to him - let me call Elly and then I will call you.

MIKA

That sounds good.

NONA

OK, be safe Mikey. I will text you where to go!

MIKEY

Of course! I'll call like in a half hour. Fisher!

The phone call stops abruptly.

MIKA

I don't think -

NONA

This guy knows what he is doing.  
Yes, yes. You keep saying that. The  
problem was with the camera. It can  
be solved.

Mika pushes chair away and rises from the table.

MIKA

What the hell kind of names are  
those. Ryan, Fisher, Amber. Was it  
Amber? Soon, names will be Coyote  
and Shooting Star. Native Americans  
will say 'You have to take that from  
us too?'

NONA

Be one thing - one thing Mika -  
nice. That child never had a  
mother. Never.

MIKA

That child is selling that house.

INT. COFFEE SHOP

MIKA is surrounded by FRIENDS 1-3.

Others are there as well.

Two play a backgammon game.

One wears a Viet Nam veteran hat.

MIKA

Bull shit. He did not have a mother  
when growing up. This, this is  
true. No mother for many years.  
But is not a 'sob story'. This is  
not Orphan Annie. Mother did not  
die in child birth. So it is fine.

FRIEND 2

Annie, she had Daddy Warbucks.  
That's no sob story either.

FRIEND 3

Warbucks, like was he a defense  
contractor? Never saw it. But I  
like the name. Warbucks.

Mika says the following.

Pronounces Tampa very badly.

MIKA

Fine. Live in Tampa.



FRIEND 2

What? Where? Who lives where?

MIKA

Tampa.

FRIEND 3

Are you saying Tampa?

MIKA

Yes, TAMPA, TAMPA, TAMPA BAY!  
Buccaneers. TAMPA!

FRIEND 2

What in the hell does that have to do with anything you just said.

MIKA

Let me explain.

FRIEND 3

Tampa is great. Tampa's great! You guys get down there watch the sunset on the Gulf it's amazing.

Viet Nam vet comments from the backgammon game.

VIET NAM VET

I liked riding my bike in Tampa a lot. When I did ride. They have these biker HOV lanes. It was wonderful.

FRIEND 3

What did you ride?

VIET NAM VET

I had a Heritage Softail. It was nice, not too heavy. You always have to be worried about the turns with heavy bikes. The Softail was fine. But the I went and bought a -  
.

MIKA

Yes, yes. Tampa is amazing. Mikey's mother leave Ivan, the father, years ago. Why, not sure. Maybe she was cheating. Maybe she just did not want to be around Ivan ... or Mikey

Mika sips coffee.

MIKA

But she move there with a carpet  
(MORE)

MIKA (CONT'D)

installer. Remarried to the installer and had two more kids. Maybe come up once or twice year. But not to see Mikey so much, which I have to admit is odd. So, it is true, he have no mother, at least not one that really wanted to see him.

FRIEND 3

Hey, man, that is rough. I mean, I can't. Like, I can't imagine what it's like to know your mom is still around. And she has two other kids. But, she sort of could care less about you. That's gotta do something to you. It cannot be easy. No way.

MIKA

Yes, it did something to him. It made him an absolute moron. Ivan, the father, is not the brightest guy.

Mika sips his coffee again.

MIKA

The kid was a mess. The milk incident.

FRIEND 2

The what incident? Mika, man, it's called context man, context.

Friends laugh.

MIKA

The milk incident is perfect example of why something wrong with him. Let me explain.

VIET NAME VET

Please do.

MIKA

The milk event. So, we are at church event. Church have a summer picnic. Big event. All families go. So - everyone is there. Many years ago, this is after Nicollette leaves Ivan, summer picnic. Not sure when - had to be the 90s sometime because Mikey was probably 6, 7?

Mika sips coffee again.

He then points to friends with index finger.

MIKA

I am sitting at a table. Crappy picnic table.

VIET NAM VET

Why was it crappy? Did you need to swing your legs over? I hate those ones.

FRIEND 3

I think they are all like that? Right?

VIET NAME VET

No, no, some of them have the benches you can pull back.

FRIEND 2

Yeah, but if people are already on the bench you still need to do the swing.

Mika ignores side conversation

MIKA

I am sitting at the table. Mikey comes over and sits across from me. Huge plate of food. And he has a chocolate milk bottle.

FRIEND 2

Like a glass one.

FRIEND 3

Old time glass one. That would be somethin. What kind of picnic is this!

MIKA

No! Not! Milk bottle. Plastic. Plastic. He sits across from. He has trouble with the cap. It's too hard for him to open. So, I am about to offer to open for him when he does this.

Mika mimics Mikey's actions for the friends.

MIKA

He take milk bottle. Look at it. Shake it. Stare at it. Then, he take bottle and smash it on the table. Like he is smashing the cap to get it off, like it's a beer  
(MORE)

MIKA (CONT'D)

bottle. Bang, bang, bang - he hits the top hard. Then he stops - and I still remember this - looks at it again and hits and smashes it again.

I say 'Mikey, is screw top. Let me take it off for you.' He look at me and grunt. Not say a word, mind you, just grunt. 'You sure you do not want me to help?' He grunt again and then he takes the bottle. Looks at it - and squeezes it. Then, he lifts it above his head.

FRIEND 2

By the power of greyskull!

MIKA

He smash as hard as he can. Cap come off. Chocolate milk go everywhere. I am soaked. He is soaked - but not nearly as much. And I say 'What the fuck are you doing! What the fuck!'

There is parent and child in a booth near.

Parent says.

PARENT

Hey, c'mon, kids. Right here?

MIKA

Sorry, sorry! Important story. Important.

Quietly and only to friends.

MIKA

Is Wednesday, 9:30, why are these kids not in school?

Then loudly again.

MIKA

I say 'I tell you cap screws off. Why did you not let me help!' And he starts bawling. Crying. So Ivan come over. 'Oh Mikey. Oh Mikey. Oh don't cry is all right.' Then to me 'Why you make Mikey cry! Why!' I say 'Me! He did this! I offered to help and take off the cap. All he do is grunt and smash stuff.' Then other people come over, the mothers mostly, and take care of him. A

(MORE)

MIKA (CONT'D)  
couple of them scold me 'He has no  
mother! Be kind Mika, be nice.'

Mika leans back and looks at ceiling.

MIKA  
And that is what happened. Everyone  
is 'nice' to Mikey. All people are  
nice to Mikey. Mikey is always  
right no matter what. Every time he  
do something, Mikey is never wrong.

FRIEND 2  
Frigging carpet installer.

MIKA  
Exactly!

INT. REAL ESTATE OFFICE

At coffee station.

Pot of coffee made.

MIKEY rummages through cupboard.

He finds packet of Swiss Miss.

Huge smile.

Mixes coffee with Swiss Miss.

Co-worker comes in.

CO-WORKER  
Running a marathon today Mikey?

MIKEY  
Poor man's mocha! But, actually,  
I'm going to do the Aurora 5k this  
year! I start training in a couple  
weeks.

Co-worker raises eyebrow as he secures a cup of coffee.

Phone rings in cube.

MIKEY  
I gotta get that.

Mikey heads to cube and grabs cell phone.

MIKEY  
This is Mikey Derogai. The guy who  
will sell your house! How can I  
help you today?

INT. MIKA'S KITCHEN

NONA listens and pages through the magazine.

MIKA holds his cell phone.

MIKA

First, by putting my number in your contacts. With my name.

MIKEY

Who is this?

MIKA

It's Nona, Mika. You are on speaker. You texted us to call you at 10AM. You text Nona on her phone. This is Mika. This is my phone.

MIKEY

Mika, Nona! So good to hear from you! I was just thinking about the house.

MIKA

We were thinking too. Any news, offers, anything?

MIKEY

No, no news.

MIKA

Um ... any questions for us? Any thoughts?

MIKEY

No, no, nothing. But I want to talk about two ideas. Two big ideas!

MIKA

OK, we are listening. What are the ideas.

MIKEY

First, we need to lower the price. We must lower it.

MIKA

OK, that I knew. What is the new price?

MIKEY

310. 310. It's a great price.

MIKA

Is still too high. Way too high.  
Make it lower please!

MIKEY

No, no, no. It is a perfect price.

MIKA

OK, but why not 300 or 299 or  
something like that. Why is 310  
more perfect then those? And note,  
those are -

MIKEY

It's a buyers market right now. A  
buyers market. Yep. In the last  
month nothing is moving.

MIKA

OK ... so a buyers market.

MIKEY

You know what that means - right?

MIKA

YES! I know what it means, I am not  
a moron. I know, I know. But  
Mikey, I do see houses selling  
online and that means -

Mikey ignores Mika's thought and plows on.

MIKEY

OK great, so we lower the price.  
Now, second idea. Open house.

MIKA

YES! Of course, we should have done  
that weeks ago. Why do you put a  
house on the market and then not  
have open house, it makes no sense.

Mikey completely ignores Mika again.

MIKEY

I want to shoot this Sunday at 1PM.  
1PM.

MIKA

OK so ...

MIKEY

Is it OK with you?

MIKA

YES! Why would it not be OK? Of  
course.

MIKEY

Well some people get worried about having people going in their house, they want to lock up the valuables, worry about stuff being broken.

MIKA

Mikey, house is empty! Remember? Katryn is dead - she is gone! We sold all the stuff. Whatever is left, they can steal!

Nona looks up from magazine and shakes head, looks disgusted.

She then motions to talk.

MIKA

Wait, one second.

Four seconds pass with focus on Mikey.

He causally looks at picture of his kids at hockey tournament on desk.

MIKA

Nona wants to be there. I have no clue why. She wants to be there.

MIKEY

Of course! Of course! Yes she can be there. Nona - I need some of your coffee! Please! Just like you made the last time.

NONA

Don't worry Mikey, I will make it! I'll remember to bring cream and sugar.

MIKA

Yes. Cream and sugar. In fact, she will bring sweetened condensed milk.

MIKEY

Oh that would be great. Nona, you make the best coffee!

MIKA

Yeah, I know. I know. Have known her for 32 years, great coffee.

MIKEY

OK, Nona be there at 12:30, we will tidy the house.



NONA

OK Mikey, will see you see you then!  
I will text the day before to make  
sure it's a go.

MIKEY

Bye, ciao!

MIKA

Bye.

Phone conversation ends.

MIKA

By tidy, does he mean to tear out  
and re-tile all the bathrooms?  
Remove 40 yards of shag carpet. Is  
Jesus going to be a part of this  
plan, should we have loaves of bread  
and fishes?

Smiling, Nona pushes a dessert to Mika.

NONA

Have some dessert. Now in this  
article, they explain how the  
costumes are selected for the Met  
Gala. It is fascinating how much  
work goes into it.

Scene goes back to real estate office.

Mikey sips the last of the 'poor mans mocha' and simply  
looks out the window.

INT. OF NONA AND MIKA'S HOUSE

Day of open house.

MIKA wanders down hallway to bathroom.

NONA is inside working on her hair.

MIKA

Buyers market. My ass buyers  
marker. You know Lydia right?  
Seva's daughter, yes?

NONA

Of course, yes I know her.

MIKA

I saw her at the supermarket. I  
tell her about the house and she,  
without me saying anything, just  
that we are selling it she says 'You  
(MORE)

MIKA (CONT'D)

will have no problem - none - it is a SELLERS market.' She just bought a house one month ago. Some street I never heard of. Says it's a sellers' marker. This guy, he does not know what he is doing.

NONA

He does! Maybe the market changed? Maybe when Lydia bought it, it was a sellers market. And now it's not!

Mika waves her off which she can see in the mirror.

MIKA

Bahh, in two months!

MIKA

Explain to me again, why do I need to go this open house? Please.

NONA

Because I have to go to Irinia's baby shower. Hello! I want to be there to explain things to Mikey about the house when arrives. But I have to leave by 1PM.

MIKA

No, I know that, I know WHY you have to leave. But why can't he just do it? Why do I need to be there at all?

NONA

To help Mikey. To help him if he needs it.

MIKA

What help is he going to need? Irinia, I do not understand why that baby shower is even happening. It is not even her first child.

NONA

OK, what do you mean 'Why'. You know exactly why she could not have a shower for the first baby. Irinia never got to have people shower here with gifts and love. It is a beautiful thing.

She continues to talk while looking in the mirror and applying makeup.

MIKA

But she is not even married. Is she even with this guy?

NONA

Yes, I am going to this baby shower. And yes, she is with 'this guy.' The live together and he will be there. His name is Martin. And one final yes, you are going to that open house.

MIKA

But what would I do there? Am I to be some random guy at a table drinking coffee 'Hey! How are you.'

Nona sips a smaller espresso cup of coffee on the bathroom counter.

NONA

I don't want anyone messing with my parent's house. Period.

MIKA

But Mikey is a grown man. A man who can do things. He can ... drive to Cleveland and get his kids asses to a hockey tournament. He can handle an open house.

Nona turns and faces Mika.

NONA

Listen, you are gonna go to that open house. You watch the house. You help Mikey.

MIKA

Fine fine. But I'm not making him a second pot of coffee.

Mika walks down hallway. Makes one last call out.

MIKA

I am going out to the library. I will be at the open house by 1 o'clock. Also, baby shower is for when you are pregnant and married. Pregnant and married.

EXT. OF TAN BRICK HOUSE

NONA'S car is in the driveway.

Multiple cars whiz by.

As MIKA walks up driveway a fat black cat hustles out of garage.

It looks at Mika disdainfully and trots away.

He walks inside.

NONA

Oh Mika, Mikey was just telling me a terrific story about Amber and the kids and how they got locked out of the house on Black Friday.

MIKEY

Yes, they went out early and -

Mika interrupts.

MIKA

Yes, I'm sure it's a great story. How is the open house? How many people have stopped to look?

MIKEY

None, yet. Officially it hasn't started.

MIKA

OK, but if people are interested wouldn't they be here already? Yes? Like to be the first ones to see it in person?

Nona ignoring Mikey.

NONA

I have to go Mikey. Good luck! Irinia's baby shower.

MIKEY

Ohhhh, she is having a shower. That is beautiful! Good for her.

NONA

I know, I know, she is so lucky.

MIKA

Yes, beautiful thing. Beautiful thing. Nona, we need to talk before you go.

NONA

Ya, ya, OK, BYE MIKEY.

MIKEY

OK, bye Nona, And hey -

He says this as though telling a secret.

MIKEY

I won't tell Amber you make the best coffee around.

NONA

Mikey!

Mika hustles her down the hallway leading out.

MIKA

I just thought of something.  
Something we need to talk about.  
The gift.

NONA

What gift. What do you mean?

MIKA

Irinia, Irinia. Gift. How much to give. Now a dinner or brunch at Heffingers. Can cost no more that \$15 dollars a plate. No more. I looked online at the catering menu.

NONA

Oh come on!

MIKA

Gift should be no more that 50 dollars. No more.

Nona laughs as she continues walking.

NONA

You are crazy. You are nuts. No one gives 50 dollars for a baby shower! A 100 dollars at least. Probably more. If you give 50, you are cheap bastard. Even if you give a 100 you sort of are. Besides, for a baby shower you give a gift.

MIKA

How much did you spend? Mind you, she is not even -

NONA

Married. I know. Mmmm. Let me think. Baby swing, embroidered bids.

Nona stops to do imaginary math in the air.

NONA

At least 200.

MIKA

What!

NONA

Yes at least 200 dollars. Maybe more.

MIKA

You can't give her that much. That's crazy!

NONA

Well I did. You stay, watch house, help Mikey.

MIKA

What, drink coffee?

NONA

Help Mikey.

Nona leaves through garage, impeccably dresses.

Mika heads to kitchen.

Pours cup of coffee and sit with Mikey.

MIKEY

Cream?

10 minutes later.

Mikey is droning on.

MIKEY

Mika, you would not believe it. You would not believe this goal.

MIKA

Yes, you must be there to appreciate.

MIKEY

He, he just from around the back of the net, he takes the puck one way, goes the other then and bang, backhands it in. Oh man, just beautiful. The team calls that play the Monte Cristo because it's so good. It's that good!

MIKA

Yes, wonderful. Fisher must be very talented.

MIKEY

Oh you have no idea. Look at this -

Door opens.

A young couple with a child enters the house.

Mikey springs into action and greets at the door.

Mika stands and motions to go but avoids the couple.

MIKEY

Welcome, welcome! So glad to have you here to see this house. I am Mikey. Who do I have the pleasure of seeing here today!

SARAH

Sarah.

JOHN

John. And this is our son

Mika is in the kitchen.

Eyes closed and listening as he stands by the sink.

John  
Atticus.

Mika nods and smiles. Opens his eyes and looks to the backyard.

MIKEY

Hey little guy! You want to see the house! Come on - come on in! This house was built for kids! It was build in 68. Well, you probably know the specs, but what's best about this house. The layout and flow. Just give it a look! If you have any questions, just give a holler!

The couple wanders around and looks at stuff.

A grossly outdated living room.

There is a massive white brick fireplace with smoke stains about the outside of it.

The husband looks at the bookshelf adjoining it.

Mikey appears behind him.

He gives no social space and becomes a member of their walk through.

MIKEY

How far along are you on the journey?

JOHN

Excuse me. Journey?

MIKEY

The house hunting journey. That journey!

JOHN

Oh, oh. Just starting. In fact we just happened to be driving by and decided to give it a look. It seemed nice. We liked the brick exterior, nice tan bricks..

MIKEY

Exactly. It's almost got a touch of strawberry red, it's very nice. Oh, all the books and all the items are still for sale. Just make an offer if you are interested!

John peruses a book.

JOHN

Uh, my Russian is a real rusty. Don't think a dictionary in Cyrillic will do me much good.

MIKEY

It's Ukrainian actually!

Sarah goes out back with child.

Mikey immediately follows.

MIKEY

Now this, this is a great yard. Great yard. Perfect for the summer and hosting parties.

SARAH

Really, how? To me it seems just OK.

MIKEY

What do you mean OK? All the fences are there, it's private. Hosting!

SARAH

Well, it's really narrow. And, uh, there is no deck. Just a big concrete ... slab. Which is ...

(MORE)



SARAH (CONT'D)  
interesting. Honey, don't fall on  
that.

Atticus is attempting to hop scotch on solid concrete  
bench.

MIKEY  
Ya know, a more confined backyard is  
actually better. You want it to  
feel cozy. Your guests will mingle  
better.

SARAH  
Um, yeah, I never thought of it like  
that. Never thought like that.  
Atticus, stop, please.

MIKEY  
Come on, let's take a look at the  
dining room. Hey, Atticus, where  
does the bounce house go!

ATTICUS  
Oh, we own one of those! We own our  
own! It's so fun!

SARAH  
Not next to the concrete slab.  
Those things tip.

All enter the house.

Sarah and child decidedly do not go to the dining room.

Mikey enters it to find John.

He is staring at the chandelier.

MIKEY  
Ahhh, you like it? That is high  
end, high end chandelier. Top of  
the line.

JOHN  
I was actually thinking it was kind  
of ugly. I mean, this is right out  
of 1972. You can see, they were  
going for like a French provincial  
look. But it's all wrong.

MIKEY  
No, no. Top of the line. This  
stuff is coming back, big! It is  
big right now. You go to a vintage  
shop and that same chandelier, you  
are looking at at least 600 or 800.

Mika stays out of eye sight but always with ear shot.

Sarah calls from the window.

SARAH

This window is ... impossible. To open.

Atticus runs through the house destructively.

Mikey is now somewhat confused.

Does not know who to address next.

MIKEY

Watch out little guy. What window. What?

SARAH

Yeah this one. It's the third window I've tried to open and no luck.

MIKEY

Let me see.

Mikey leverages a crank handle of a casement window.

Full weight hit.

A not so good cracking sound is heard as the window pops open.

MIKEY

See, see, it works fine. Just need to put some oomph into it.

JOHN

Wow, uh, this is an old kitchen.

SARAH

Is that ... is that a bay of fluorescent lights. Oh my God. I feel like I'm in an Amazon warehouse.

The center of the kitchen is dominated by a massive bay of fluorescent lights with an old, discolored plastic covering.

MIKEY

No, no, it's not old. No way. I've sold many many houses. This kitchen is not old. Believe me I have seen old. You have no idea! It's in great condition. A little paint. A new fixture. It's spot on.

Sarah walks to the stove. The stove is brown, clearly of the 70s.

SARAH

No ... yes. No ... yes. Yes! This is. This is exactly the stove my grandmother had. The exact one. It's got that brown color that fades a bit away from the edges. Wow.

She is now peering into the stove.

JOHN

What the hell is this?

MIKEY

Oh, the microwave!

A behemoth microwave sits below a cabinet.

It looks the size of washing machine.

MIKEY

See, it's got great capacity. Great capacity. I am pretty sure you can microwave like a 20 pound turkey in it. At least. 20 pounds for sure.

SARAH

I've ... a microwaved turkey. It sounds terrible but I almost want to try it. What would it be like?

Mika just listens from other rooms but close to the front door.

He wants to be unseen but observing.

He carries the house listing sheet to appear as a potential buyer.

Mikey is smiling and motions to the couple.

MIKEY

Come on. The best part!

He motions by the kitchen hallway to follow.

SARAH

What? What part.

MIKEY

The upstairs!

SARAH

This hallway is so dark.

MIKEY

No, no, the lighting is fine. Just needs a bigger bulb.

JOHN

Actually, it's a long hallway. It needs more lights.

MIKEY

Nope, just a stronger bulb. You'll see!

Sarah and John are startled.

They step into the bathroom at the top of the stairs.

MIKEY

Now, this bathroom. High-end. Everything in here, high end.

JOHN

Yeah ... of a time.

Mikey looks perplexed.

He plows on.

MIKEY

They simply don't make stuff like this any more. No way. Quality. Quality. The stuff today is crap. Look at this shower. Two shower heads - two!

JOHN

Wow, I can't believe they tiled the ceiling.

SARAH

With pink tiles.

MIKEY

Exactly! They spared no expense! I mean none. Just crank up that shower on hot and you can make this bathroom a sauna. With the tiles, it radiates heat.

SARAH

A pink .... toilet.

MIKEY

Oh, those can be painted. I know someone. Easy fix.

John from the hallway.

JOHN

Wow. Wow.

MIKEY

Master bedroom. Master. It's huge.

JOHN

It's wood paneled. Who wood panels their bedroom? Are you sure this isn't the den or something? But it can't be because there's the closet.

MIKEY

No, it's a bedroom. And do checkout the closet. What I like about the wood, it's warm. Is a warm feeling, like a Swiss chalet. Warm.

SARAH

It's like a lodge feel. I sort of get it.

Atticus rushes in and pounds on the wood.

MIKEY

Hey little guy!

Downstairs Mika works the window and nothing happens.

The handle just spins.

He looks disgusted.

Upstairs all enter a new room.

MIKEY

What did I tell you. High end. They do not make sound systems like this anymore. No way. This - it comes with the house. With the house! Listen to it.

Mikey turns on the stereo.

Classic music pumps out at a high volume.

JOHN

It's the best I've ever heard.

MIKEY

Look around some more! This whole place is primo. One other thing, look out this window. Those, those are all 500 thousand dollar houses. Right behind you. Right behind you!

John and Sarah nod.

The couple leaves to explore more of the house while Atticus runs like mad.

FIVE MINUTES LATER

Mika and Mikey talking in the kitchen.

MIKEY

They say that after 10 minutes you should not drink the coffee. No matter how good the carafe is. 10 minutes! But - I can never tell any difference.

Mika looks at the listing printout when Sarah and John come back in.

Atticus can be heard in the background playing with the sound system.

Mika pretends to be a buyer.

MIKA

Well thank you for the description, I am going to look around.

JOHN

Well thank you for showing us this house!

SARAH

Yeah, it was great! Atticus - get down here!

MIKA

I am going to look around the front.

Mika holds up the listing pretends to read and walks down the front hallway.

As he exits you can hear the conversation between Sarah, John, and Mikey.

Mika begins to weed by the entrance steps.

Eventually the couple exits.

JOHN

It's nice. It is nice. The layout is great. ATTICUS!

SARAH

Yeah, I like it. It needs a lot of work. ATTICUS GET OUT HERE!

JOHN

Uh - ya think! It's way overpriced.

SARAH  
No, no. It's vintage. Vintage!

JOHN  
Oh, thanks Mikey

John looks at the card

JOHN  
Derogai.

Atticus tears down the driveway leaping and breaking a tree branch on the tree along the way.

SARAH  
John, stop him before he gets to the STREET! John.

Mika ignores them and heads into the house.

He arrives in the kitchen to see no one.

Then, Mikey re-enters.

MIKEY  
Oh, had to turn off the stereo. The sound on that thing is amazing. I might take it.

Mikey then heads to the fridge and pulls out a massive sub.

He proceeds to unroll the paper and takes a huge bite.

He looks out the kitchen window he opened earlier.

MIKA  
Yes. Well?

MIKEY  
Oh ... that ... that went really well!

MIKA  
Really, you think it went well? Why? Why you think that?

MIKEY  
They had many questions - and I answered them all. All of them!

MIKA  
Really? What questions did they have?

MIKEY

Oh, they thought stuff was wrong.  
But I explained how it was good.  
Head em' off at the pass. Make a  
negative a positive. Works every  
time.

MIKA

So, now what?

MIKEY

They will offer. I guarantee it.  
Probably tomorrow morning. Monday  
morning.

MIKA

I don't know Mikhail. They seemed  
not so interested.

MIKEY

Mika. Mika! I do this for a  
living! I can read people. They  
are interested. I know it.

As he bites the sub Mika leans to the window.

He spins a clearly broken handle.

MIKA

I think ... you might have broke  
this.

Mikey looks disbelieving.

He then spins it.

Spins it again.

MIKEY

Oh, it's an easy fix. Easy fix! I  
know exactly what is wrong.

INT. COFFEE SHOP

MIKA is with his FRIENDS.

MIKA

And that ... that is what happened  
at the open house. But I suspect  
this will happen next.

Friend 3 looks at watch.

FRIEND 3

Mika, Mika, I gotta go. Sorry.



FRIEND 2

Where are you going?

FRIEND 3

I gotta get a blood draw. And if I wait another half hour, then the senior center mini-bus comes and it's impossible.

FRIEND 2

You OK - blood draw?

FRIEND 3

Diabetes. Just that. I have a doctors appointment next week.

FRIEND 2

I never knew that. One or two?

FRIEND 3

Two. Two man.

FRIEND 2

My brother-in-law has that.

Friend 3 rises.

FRIEND 3

Yeah a lot of people do. Like half the country dude.

FRIEND 2

No, no, no. He is Type 1 though. My wife is always worried about this guy. She is calling like crazy. 'You OK? Did you take your insulin? What's your A1C?' He never takes care of himself. So, it's like I'm living with Type 1 diabetic.

FRIEND 3

He got one of these?

Friend 3 shows a glucose monitor on his upper arm.

FRIEND 2

Don't ... I know what that is.

Friend 3 laughs.

FRIEND 2

He has one. Lazy ass. My wife, get this, wanted to set my phone up so I got alerts on his A1C from his monitor. So I would be the one to call or text and remind him. 'Fuck no!' I said.

Friend 3 leaves.

FRIEND 2

All right, I'll see you tomorrow. I think. Maybe. We'll see. You gonna be here?

MIKA

I think.

Friend 2 gets up and leaves as well.

Mika sits alone.

He then sees the same person with the children.

Earlier he had scolded Mika for his language.

MIKA

Hey, hey, homeschooler.

The adult looks at Mika.

MIKA

Yes you. I know you are listening to story. What do you think?

HOMESCHOOLER

I have a name. It's Randy. You know that. It's a long story. All your stories are long. But it's ... interesting at least.

MIKA

I have no choice. No choice but to help. I watched a special by Deepak.

Homeschooler then looks to Mika.

His children quietly read.

He holds up an index finger, ponders, and then asks.

HOMESCHOOLER

Deepak? Do you mean Deepak Chopra?

MIKA

Yes, yes. Chopra. Chopra. Deepak Chopra.

Homeschooler then sets down his sandwich he held in the other hand.

He then turns to look at Mika.

HOMESCHOOLER

You watch Deepak Chopra.

MIKA

Yes, on the PBS. He say you need to push the thoughts out of your mind. Do not think about bad things until there is a positive. Everything in life is a journey but you have to find the light at the end of that journey. So, that made sense to me, it is what I do.

HOMESCHOOLER

Wow. OK. Well. Wow. For the record here I hear what you guys say. I don't just park my kids at Dunkin Donuts. We start school at 06:30. This is just a break.

MIKA

Oh, I am sorry! I am sorry. They read beautifully, better behaved than all the other animal kids I see.

HOMESCHOOLER

I also have a PhD and they are getting an education 100 times better than any school.

MIKA

PhD? PhD? In what, what?

HOMESCHOOLER

Philosophy.

Mika nods.

Silently sips coffee.

His Viet Nam friend had been using the bathroom and returns.

He is trying to figure out cross word.

He proclaims.

VIET NAM

Five letter for 'Ensures a good relationship with your neighbors'.

All ignore him except one of the children who, without looking up, says.

CHILD

Fence.

MIKA

OK, see, that is problem. Now it makes sense. See that is why your wife has to work. You should have gotten a PhD in something more ... um ... marketable.

HOMESCHOOLER

It's marketable. Trust me, it is. I got a PhD because I wanted to get it. Not because I was looking for a big pay day. It's because I wanted it. And what the hell degree do you have, by the way.

MIKA

Oh, I have a degree. But do not get me started. You have asked the wrong question. Have a degree in what you call in America civil engineering. Best institute in Ukraine. Best by far. But they would not accept the courses.

Homeschooler laughs.

HOMESCHOOLER

Probably some two year technical college - -

Mika is quickly annoyed.

MIKA

Hardly! Four year program! Heavy math, physics, all of it better, BETTER, than degree is US.

VIET NAM

I gotta go.

Mika looks at watch.

MIKA

Yes, I as well. OK, philosophy, that story is for another day. You have to wait. By boys!

Mika waves bye to two children.

They continue to read unflinchingly.

One has Lake Wobegon Days.

The other the autobiography of Steve Young.

INT. SCREENED IN PORCH

Nona and Mika sit.

Nona is watching a TV mounted on the wall.

A talk show is on with hosts sipping coffee and laughing.

Mika reads the paper.

NONA

They are going to have Miley Cyrus  
on next.

MIKA

Yes, Miley.

NONA

I think she has a beautiful voice.  
Really, just beautiful.

MIKA

Well if she is on this show I doubt  
much she is going to sing. You know  
we must call him.

Nona continues watching and laughs.

NONA

OK, OK. Call him.

Mika calls on phone and places into speaker.

NONA

I don't need to hear this! I am  
watching this show. Go inside! Or  
take it off speaker.

Mika waves her off and takes the phone off speaker.

MIKEY

Hello, this is Mikey Derogai. The  
guy who will sell your house! How  
can I help you!

MIKA

Two ways, first put my frigging  
number in your contacts so you know  
it's me, Mika. Second, you can sell  
my house! As in, actually sell it.

MIKEY

Mika! Wait, are you looking to sell  
your house too, your current one?

MIKA

Mikey, the house you are selling for us. Just that one. Updates? Anything?

MIKEY

Well ... no, no nothing. How is Nona?

MIKA

She is fine, great. What about that couple, that couple you were so sure of at the open house. Anything?

MIKEY

Well, they are young. Young and, like, afraid. Typical first time home buyers. Can't recognize a value when it's staring them in the face. Just can't see the forest for the -

Mika interrupts.

MIKA

Mikey, I do not think they are young and stupid. They have a kid, they probably have a house. They probably want more kids and a bigger house.

MIKEY

Yeah, yeah, maybe. Maybe that.

MIKA

So?

MIKEY

So ... what?

MIKA

So what do we do now? The house, the house. What now. We do want to sell the damn thing.

MIKEY

Ohhh .... of course. Of course.

MIKA

What is going on over there, is this a bad time? What are you doing?

MIKEY

No, no! It's a fine time to talk. Here is what I think. I still think \$310 is the right number. But ... a house gets stale.

MIKA

Stale?

MIKEY

Yeah, stale. On the market. People who are looking know about it and just zip right past it. I think if we take it off the market for two months and put it back on, then ... we might find ourselves in a sellers market.

MIKA

Are you out of your mind! Take it off the market. Mikey, what if there are people who like the house, who want the house, but this voice in head, that voice, it says 'This house is great but costs too much.' Damn it, cut the price a lot, get reasonable price and move it.

NONA

Be nice! Be kind. Oh, Miley is on after this commercial.

MIKEY

But you want to maximize profit.

MIKA

Yeah, I know. Maximize what? We have no skin in this game. Everything we get is profit - all. All is profit.

MIKEY

Oh ... Nona, is this what you want?

MIKA

You are not on speaker!

Nona talking louder but continuing to watch the TV.

NONA

Mikey, I can hear you! I trust you. Lets keep the price at \$310 for ... two weeks. Two more weeks. Then we lower it.

MIKEY

Nona, that is a terrific idea!

MIKA

I thought this house is stale. Now, two weeks is a good idea. Why?

NONA

Mikey, we will see you on Sunday at church. We can talk more then. I need to see what Miley says.

MIKEY

Oh sorry Nona, I am out of town this weekend.

Mika mutes phone.

MIKA

Real estate agent who is always away on weekend!

Mika unmutes.

MIKEY

Taking Amber and the kids to the Poconos.

MIKA

What, no hockey tournament?

MIKEY

Oh no, that's over, thankfully! This is sort of celebration of the season ... sort of!

MIKA

Poconos. Why the Poconos? What are they?

MIKEY

Oh, a resort town in Allegheny Pennsylvania! Really fun place. You and Nona should go! I have a timeshare there.

NONA

I would love to go Mikey. Mika, come, watch, Miley is going to sing. Come. She has such a lovely voice.

INT. OF CHURCH

Sunday congregation in a Ukrainian orthodox church.

The PRIEST is at the altar.

PRIEST

And, of course, first Sunday of the month so we have donuts and coffee in the congregation room.



## INT. CONGREGATION ROOM

Families and older folks are piled in a line awaiting free donuts and coffee.

The priest talks with people and is speaking to an older man.

IVAN

Father, I am blessed. I blessed.

PRIEST

Of course you are Ivan. Of course.

IVAN

Truly, I am blessed. I have a wonderful wife, made me a new man 12 years ago. A new man. Have beautiful children and grand children. I just think about it the other night.

PRIEST

Thought what?

IVAN

I have a child who is a lawyer, an engineer, and a real estate agent. I was driving on the freeway. The other day. And there is a billboard. On it ... is my child. Mikey. He is on it. And I think 'That's my son!'

Mika listens in the background and finally can hold back no longer.

MIKA

Really. You are blessed. Really.

IVAN

Yes, I just said I am.

MIKA

Let me ask you something otets. Just one question. What makes a successful real estate agent.

PRIEST

Um ... they sell houses! Or help people buy houses.

MIKA

'They sell houses.'

IVAN

What? What you talking about??!!

Ivan to his wife.

IVAN

What is he talking about?

MIKA

Successful real estate agents, they sell houses.

IVAN

Yes, we know that Mika!

MIKA

So, if a real estate agent has a house for three months and gets no walk throughs, no calls, no offers. Is that successful? Is it?

People taking in the conversation look confused at one another.

Ivan sets down his coffee.

IVAN

Wait, wait, wait, wait, wait. This about Nona's house! Isn't it? This is about her house. Nona, is this about your house?

Nona looks from her conversation but has no clue what is transpiring.

She is too far away to hear.

NONA

What?

MIKA

Has nothing to do with the house. Is just a ... how do they say ... hypothetical question. Does that make a successful real estate agent?

IVAN

I'll tell you right now as I stand here - Mikey is good real estate agent. Good agent! He has sold 100s of houses. 100s! He drives a BMW! He will have NO PROBLEM selling Nona's house.

MIKA

First, it's our house. Second, all he need to do is sell the house. Right?

PRIEST

Look, I'm just a priest. I don't  
about know real estate and all that.  
But have faith in God that it will  
come to be.

MIKA

Then all he needs do is sell the  
house. That is it. Just sell the  
house.

Nona looks to Mika not fully hearing everything.

IVAN

He WILL sell that house! He will  
sell it. Maybe, maybe, if you had a  
better house it is easier to sell.

MIKA

Believe me, the house is fine.  
There is something else that is not  
so fine that makes it hard to sell.

IVAN

What the -

Ivan then pushes Mika. Mika pushes back. Priest steps  
in.

PRIEST

Please, please. 17 years we have  
done this and this is the first  
fight at donut day. Please!

Ivan wave off priest.

IVAN

Is not fight. Is minor  
disagreement. (pointing to Mika).  
He will sell Nona's house. He will.

MIKA

Our house. Not just Nona.

IVAN

He will sell the piece of shit - you  
do not worry. Where is my coffee?

INT. OF CAR

NONA and MIKA with Mika driving.

Nona is flustered.

NONA

Why did you do that. Why? Why,  
why, why, in a church!

MIKA

It was just a minor disagreement.  
And because he is is an idiot and I  
could stand it no longer.

NONA

But in church, Mika, really. We  
know these people. I am taking a  
bus trip with Mila this week to the  
casino! Oh I cannot go.

MIKA

You can go. You go. I only spoke  
the truth.

NONA

And physically pushed it.

MIKA

No, no, no, no! Not that! Ivan  
pushed first.

NONA

Children. Children. I have not had  
these problems since we had 10 year  
olds in the house. This is EXACTLY  
how I would feel when they would do  
something stupid in public. And  
what do you mean 'spoke the truth.'

MIKA

Ivan. Proclamations. 'I am  
blessed. I am blessed.' Daughter  
is a lawyer, yes, this is true. But  
a DUI defending attorney. You see  
the ads. And the other son is NOT  
an engineer by the way.

NONA

What do you mean? Why do you even  
care?

MIKA

No, an engineer goes to four year of  
college. He went to technical  
school for two years to be a  
facilities engineer. Do you know  
what a facilities engineer is? Do  
you? They are glorified janit -

Phone rings. Nona immediately hits screen to send it to  
speaker.

NONA

Hello.

MIKEY

Mika?

NONA

Mikey! It is Nona! We just saw your father at church. I am so sorry -

MIKEY

Oh, that's great. Great! I have other news. We ... have ... an ... offer!

MIKA

Holy crap.

NONA

Mikey - that is great! What is the price?

MIKEY

Um ... I don't know. I don't know!

MIKA

How could you not know? Isn't an offer typically a number?

MIKEY

Oh yes, yes, yeah. It is. They sent it as a PDF and my phone is not reading PDFs. So I want -

MIKA

Whatever. When can you read the thing.

MIKEY

We are coming home from the Poconos right now. I'll know tonight.

NONA

Mikey - this is great. You will stop by in the morning. Tomorrow. I will have coffee and cake. And it will be a price reveal.

MIKEY

Oh yeah! A reveal party.

NONA

How were the Poconos.

MIKEY

Oh Nona, you have to go. You need to make Mika take you there. I feel completely re-energized. Completely!

Mika rolls eyes and continues driving as Mikey and Nona make more small talk.

EXT. OF HOUSE

MIKEY's finger reaches out to press the doorbell.

MIKA  
Come in Mikey. Come in.

MIKEY  
Hello, hello, hello! Say hello to the guy who is going to sell your house!

MIKA  
Yes, hello.

NONA  
Oh Mikey, come to the kitchen. Come, get some coffee.

MIKEY  
Oh wow, what type of cake is that?

NONA  
It is a new thing they have at the Price Chief. It is cake in a cup. It's great! Try it. Try it!

MIKEY  
OK!

MIKA  
How about we get the price first.

Mikey sits at the table.

Mikey begins scarfing down cake.

MIKEY  
Oh, the price is low. But we can work it.

MIKA  
What is the price.

NONA  
Yes, the price.

MIKA  
285.

MIKA  
That's ... an amazing price.

He stares at Mikey in disbelief..

MIKA

That is an AMAZING price.

NONA

Oh Mikey, that is great. Is great price!

MIKEY

I printed the contract. They actually sent over a contract. Sometimes they do a verbal, 'You gonna even consider this?' But look, a contract.

Mika takes contract and begins to read it.

NONA

How did you do it Mikey? Did you know these people? Did you show the house last week?

MIKEY

No, no. They saw the house online, they saw the pictures and they were good with it.

NONA

It is amazing. I wonder if we should counter. No, we should not. We should start looking in Ft. Lauderdale. Mika, you know the markets, what does \$285 get us?

MIKA

Not much I think.

MIKEY

The people seem great. They even sent a note. I printed that too. Listen to this 'Dear Owner of 6722 Main Street, We love your house! From the second we saw the tan brick and backyard we knew it would be perfect for our family and Teddy.'

MIKA

Teddy. Who is Teddy? What is Teddy? Is that a child?

MIKEY

No. Maybe? I don't think so. I think it's the dog.

Mika still reading the contract.

MIKA

Or maybe the cat.

MIKEY

'We love everything about the house.  
It will be perfect for our move  
back to Aurora. We hope so much you  
accept this offer. This is the home  
where I family will grow. Sincerely,  
Theresa Ann Miller-Marjean.'

Mika places hand to forehead.

He walks to Mikey and places hand on shoulder.

Looks him in the eyes and says, smiling.

MIKA

Oh, fuck. This is too good  
actually.

MIKEY

What?

Nona is livid.

NONA

Wait, read that again. Again!

MIKEY

'Dear Owner of '

NONA

No, not that part. The name. The  
name. Just the name.

MIKEY

Theresa Ann Marjean-Miller. I like  
it when the keep the maiden name ...  
but I never know which one it is.

MIKA

Oh it's Marjean. I am sure. Wow.  
Wow. Just ... wow!

NONA

Give me that letter now. Oh ...  
give me that letter.

MIKEY

Whats going on?

He reads the name slowly

MIKEY

Theresa Ann Marjean-Miller

NONA

Let me guess. Oh, let me guess.  
(MORE)



NONA (CONT'D)

Mrs. Theresa Ann Marjean-Miller  
wants to be closer to grandmother.  
Hmmm ... how nice. How nice. Want  
to help and take care of the bitch  
grandmother.

Mikey happily.

MIKEY

Oh, so you know them! Yes, yes.  
The real estate agent mentioned  
that! I thought it was really  
sweet. Her grandmother lives right  
behind the house. So, she want to  
extend the back walk and connect -

Nina interrupts.

NINA

Mikey, she will put in NOTHING. Not  
one damn thing. We will never ....  
NEVER ... sell to MAR-JEAN. I need  
to call my sister right now.

Mika sighs.

Sits at the table and beings to eat one of the cakes in  
the cup.

He then pushes one toward Mikey.

MIKA

Here.

In the background you hear Nona rattling off details to  
her sister.

Then, loudly, you hear 'MAR-JEAN' and then again  
'MAR-FUCKING-JEAN'

MIKEY

What ... is going on?

MIKA

Oh Mikey. You have done many things  
wrong with selling this house. Many  
things. But this - you did nothing  
wrong. Could not have seen it  
coming up. Could not. Even I am  
surprised. The cake is good though,  
yes?

MIKEY

Who is Marjean? Why won't she sell?

MIKA

Mikey, I cannot make a coffee strong enough to discuss. You need a real drink.

Mika heads to a liquor globe in the adjacent dining room.

He returns with a liter of Seagrams VO.

He then pours it into Mikey's coffee.

MIKEY

Oh, I only drink clear hard liquors.

Mika ignores the proclamation.

MIKA

How was the Poconos.

FIVE MINUTES PASS

Mika and Mikey talking at the table.

MIKEY

So now, Fisher is not sure if he likes hockey better than lacrosse.

MIKA

Hmmm, what a problem. What problems.

MIKEY

Exactly! He can't possibly be on both travel teams at the same time.

MIKA

Oh no, no, not possible. What is a travel team?

Nona enters.

NONA

Well she agrees. We cannot sell the house. We WILL NOT sell the house to them. No. We burn the house down before we sell to them.

MIKEY

Why? Why not? Honestly ... it might be the best offer we get.

Mikey looks to Mika for help.

MIKEY

I am starting to think the house might be priced too high.

Mika nods and sips his coffee.

MIKEY

Can we not just sell this?

NINA

No. Mikey. No. We cannot. No, we will not sell the house to them. Never.

Nona sits at the table. Mikey looks to the silent Mika and Nona. Mika sips his coffee and flips through a magazine.

MIKEY

Um ... why? Why not? Really, it might be the best offer we get.

MIKA

Tell the story. Explain. Or I will.

NONA

I will gladly explain. Many years ago, Mikey, my mother had an herb garden in the back of the house. This was her pride and joy. You know the brick path. They were filled with flowers and herbs on the side leading to the bitch neighbor's house. In the very back were the herbs. And let me tell you, these were special.

She points to Mikey.

NONA

When my mother left the Ukraine she was on a flight out of a communist country. And in her purse were the herbs. The ones from her parent's garden. She saved six types. We used them for everything. Seasoning, teas, everything. They were in her purse as small seedlings wrapped in damp napkins. Somehow. Somehow, she made it through customs in the U.S. And when she was settled at her cousins, she planted those seedlings. And they lived. For her, this was home. These herbs were home. They were home. When she gets to the house on Main Street, she plants those herbs in the back garden. It is the only place in the U.S. you can get these. The only place.

MIKEY

Wow.

NONA

Yes, wow. Every year she save the seeds and plant them to grow more and more. She had everything. She had one type of mint, one type. Ukrainian mint. That one was - what did that bitch call it - what was the name Mika?

MIKA

Invasive.

NONA

Yes, 'invasive'

MIKEY

Invasive. It takes over.

NONA

Exactly. If you do not control it, weed it, then it takes over. So, one afternoon I am in the back with mother weeding, watering. Marjean comes over. She says 'What is that?' Points to the mint. My mother says 'It's mint. It's wonderful! Use it in salads, dry it and mix it with chamomile tea.' And Marjean says 'Well, it's everywhere in my garden.' And she points to her piece of shit garden. Which, I mind you, she never tended to. Always got the Mexicans to do the work. Annuals, mulch, she never planted a damn thing. So my mother says 'I will weed it, Marjean, it's not a problem.' And I remember Marjean, she lift up her hand and says 'Well, I can't be expected to weed. I can't' And my mother says 'I said I will weed, I will weed.' Marjean then says 'Don't worry - I will take care of it. Don't worry.' And she walks away. I still remember her fat ass walking away.

Nona sips coffee and reflects. Then dives into description.

NONA

So my mother thinks nothing of it. One week passes, two weeks pass. Then she comes in one day and says  
(MORE)

NONA (CONT'D)

'I think, I think something is happening to the garden. The plants in the back, they look yellow. Not good.' Two days later the entire herb garden, dead. Dead. Dead, dead, dead. So I go with her to look. And Marjean comes out. My mother says 'My garden. My garden. What happened?' Marjean admits she had the Mexicans working for Andrews spray and kill 'weeds'. She says most of my mothers herbs are invasive. So they sprayed our yard!

MIKEY

They can't do that.

NONA

I know! We know! Marjean swears they did not spray mother's garden. But we know. We know they did. My mother, she sits at back window and looks at the garden and cry. Cry, cry, cry for months. And nothing - NOTHING - grows there for two years. Just dead, yellow, for two years. Mother finally got kale to grow there. When she ate the kale she tasted the weed killer in it and threw it out. She had an amazing sense of smell. She never planted there again. Eventually it turned to grass.

MIKEY

So how did they make restitution?

NONA

What? Never. No apology. No nothing. My father tell Marjean's husband to stay off property. He only says 'Hmmmph. That's all. 'Hmmmph'.

Then she says directly to Mikey.

NONA

Mikey, you have done a fine job selling the house. A fine job. But this offer. These people. No - no we cannot sell to them. Ever.

MIKEY

Ever? This contract is good for 24 hours. You have to respond. I mean  
(MORE)

MIKEY (CONT'D)

- that's it. You really me to say  
... no.

NINA

Yes.

MIKA

No.

NINA

Yes!

Mika flips through magazine.

MIKA

No!

NINA

Mikey - decline now. Now!

MIKEY

No, no, no - let's just wait. Take  
a deep breath. Yes. Marjean is bad  
- clearly a devil - we know. But  
let's just think. Four months it's  
been on the market and this is our  
first offer. Maybe we should take  
it.

NINA

Mikey, decline the offer. Give me  
the phone - I will gladly tell  
Marjean-Miller where to stick the  
offer.

MIKA

Just ... give it the night. Just  
one night. Think about it.  
Marjean-Miller is not Marjean. She  
is some granddaughter. And besides,  
we can't discriminate on offers.

NINA

Granddaughter. She is the same  
blood.

MIKA

Yes, I know. Yes. But can we just  
sell this thing?

NINA

Never.

MIKEY

What about one night? Just think  
(MORE)

MIKEY (CONT'D)  
about it over the night. We can  
decide in the morning.

NONA  
OK ... OK. One night. Just ... one  
night.

Nona leaves the room.

MIKEY  
Well, it sort of has to be one  
night. We have to reply. Really,  
they are going to be surprised if we  
don't respond tonight. What are -

MIKA  
The chances she comes back and says  
sell? About zero. Yes, about zero.

MIKEY  
We are communicating, right? Us?

MIKA  
What? You and me? Um - yes. We  
are. We are communicating.

MIKEY  
Look ... I don't know if there is  
... if there is another offer out  
there. I mean, I though I had this  
one ... figured out. But (looks  
Mika in the eyes) ... she needs to  
take this offer. I need to tell you  
something.

Mika sighs and turns the Seagrams VO bottle to read the  
label.

MIKA  
What, what do you need to tell me.

MIKEY  
I haven't sold a house in two  
months. This is not good for me. I  
actually ... need the money from the  
commission. The back of napkin math  
is getting rough!

MIKA  
Look. Here is my best advice. The  
Church is still open. So ... go  
there. Light a candle. Pray.  
Pray, pray, pray she changes her  
mind.

MIKEY

Will she?

MIKA

I don't know. Really, I do not.  
The chance is not zero, maybe the  
chance is ... 40%? The Marjean  
thing ... it runs deep. Frigging  
herb garden like some metaphor of  
life for that family. It was very  
important.

MIKEY

What do I tell the buyers?

MIKA

That there is an answer tomorrow.

MIKEY

Tomorrow.

INT. KITCHEN

The next morning.

MIKA is eating a bowl of Corn Puffs with a cup of coffee.

NONA is reading a magazine in the living room.

MIKA

We are out of Puffs. Out of Corn  
Puffs.

NONA

There are Cheerios. Eat those.

MIKA

No point. No reason. We need more  
Puffs. Just get those.

NONA

How about you finish the Cheerios.

The house phone rings. Mika answers it.

MIKA

Hello?

PHONE VOICE

It's Marjean.

MIKA

Yes, who?

PHONE VOICE

Marjean.



MIKA

Marjean.

NONA

Marjean?

MARJEAN

Yes, Marjean. This is the the Boyko residence, correct?

MIKA

Oh, yes it is!

Nona comes into the kitchen.

MIKA

It's Marjean.

MARJEAN

I want to talk with Nona.

INT. COFFEE SHOP

Mika is with his fiends.

FRIEND 1

She talked with Marjean?

MIKA

Talk is uh ... one way to put it. Argue. Scream. Swear. Is a better way.

FRIEND 2

Did you take the offer, you are idiot if you didn't. You know that. 280 K after taxes, come on. Of course you take it!.

MIKA

We did not. I would take it. I would take it today. No problem with Marjean. Who cares. It happened 30 years ago. Besides, the mint was fucking terrible. They put it in everything. Salads, fruit salads, with meats, they dried it 'Try the tea! Try the tea!' I hated it. It was horrible. I was secretly glad when it died. Glad.

FRIEND 1

So what the hell they say to each other?

MIKA

Oh, she try a sob story first. She say how much she need the granddaughter. She had a hip surgery and it mostly worked but she still has mobility issues. And Nona says 'The offer is too low. Why not go to an old folks home where you should be.' Said it would be easier for her. Then, Marjean blow her top. Says she knew the offer would never be accepted and that the granddaughter was an idiot to write the letter. Nona says 'Well we agree on something at least, your granddaughter is a moron.' Then Marjean says the offer is off the table. I guess the grandmother was fronting some part of it. Now she thinks this will spite Nona by not making the offer. Nona could care less, she is just happy Marjean is not happy. I tell you, she would literally burn the house down before selling it to her. But it is unfortunate.

FRIEND 1

Yeah, for you.

Mika searches for the crossword puzzle in the newspaper.

MIKA

Actually, more for Mikey. He called her, Nona, and says 'Please try to make amends with Marjean. Please, let's sell this house.' She tells him to have faith. She has prayed that the house will sell. Then he calls me. He calls me, separately. He says he is out of options. 'Mikey' I say 'Just lower the price and you will sell the house.' He says he will, but he really needs the money. He then, get this, explain to me all of his costs. The BMW lease, the cost for the travel team hotels, and all this math, and numbers. The guy has no money - none. Nothing in savings, he is living month to month. So I tell him, just try to sell more houses at reasonable price and get more overall commission. But, this is Mikey. Mikey always wants a silver bullet. Here he has a house which  
(MORE)

MIKA (CONT'D)

he is both buyer and seller agent.  
He gets ALL of the 6% because Nona  
says 'Oh, let him have it all.' and  
he wastes months of time to attempt,  
attempt, to get 18 K instead of 14  
K.

FRIEND 1

Oh man.

VIET NAM VET

What the hell's a travel team.

MIKA

Uh ... a scam I am pretty sure. It  
sounds like it when it is described  
to me. Triple A is involved I am  
sure. Basically families travel  
across states to stay over night at  
hotel, watch kid play a game, and  
then go home. Or maybe all in one  
day if parent properly caffeinated.

Mika looks at phone.

MIKA

Hold on ... he is ... he is calling  
me right now.

FRIEND 2

Who?

MIKA

Hello?

MIKEY

Hello, Mika?

MIKA

Yes Mikey, it is. Typically when  
you call a person's cell phone you  
get that person. Did you add me to  
the contacts yet?

MIKEY

Yeah, yes. Sure!

MIKA

Oh Mikey, again, sorry about the  
house. I tried one last time to  
speak with Nona - but - it is too  
much.

Mikey optimistically.

MIKEY

No, no, I understand! I understand!  
I want to talk about a potential  
idea for the house. We need to talk  
about it.

MIKA

OK, lets talk.

MIKEY

No, in person. We need to talk in  
person. I want to talk in person.

MIKA

Oh wow, why not over the phone.  
Can't we just talk over the phone.  
I'm not doing something illegal  
Mikey!

MIKEY

No, no, no, no, no, no! Oh God, no.  
We just need to talk in person.

MIKA

Yeah, you have informed me about 20  
times. Just come to the house. I  
am NOT talking about anything  
without Nona.

MIKEY

Of course! Nona should be there.  
Today would be great.

MIKA

OK, then come over. Or do you want  
us to come to the office?

MIKEY

Let's do it over lunch. Dino's  
Cafe. Lunch at noon.

MIKA

I think that will work for Nona. I  
just call her.

MIKEY

OK, great. Great! Then ... lunch at  
noon.

MIKA

OK, lunch at noon. What is this  
about -

MIKEY

Bye.

Mika sips coffee and looks to friends.

MIKA

Any of you want to come to lunch? I am going to make his ass pay.

FRIEND 2

Ha!

FRIEND 1

I do like Dinos. You know if you order the pancakes or french toast they actually give you these little bottles or real maple syrup. Like the real stuff. They come from Dover Vermont!

Mika sips coffee and looks out window.

MIKA

Dahh ... not fortunate. I had plans for this afternoon.

FRIEND 2

I wonder how much a Dunkin Donuts franchise costs.

MIKA

I was going to go the library and read the latest issue of the New Yorker. Today is the day it comes in. If I get there early enough I can beat the women who drives the Audi who also likes to read it.

FRIEND 1

What's he want to talk about? What do you think.

MIKA

I have no clue. However, I will bring him here someday. One day. You will meet Mikey. You will realize, whatever he need talk about, is never good.

FRIEND 1

And why not over the phone.

MIKA

Exactly. Never good. I hate this shit. Why does he need to talk.

Mika looks out the window and thinks.

FRIEND 2

Maybe he's ... dying.

FRIEND 1

Yeah, right, that's always something people want the 'We need to talk in person.' conversation for. Yeah, my money is on he is dying.

MIKA

No. No. That would be too easy.

INT. DINER SETTING.

Busy diner, lots of people, staff, and menagerie of items like highchairs, sweepers.

Very blue collar.

MIKA and NONA enter.

HOSTESS

How many? For two?

NONA

No, no, we are meeting someone.

Mikey is talking to a waitress and Nona sees him.

NONA

Mikey!

HOSTESS

Oh, you are meeting Mikey. Go on over.

MIKA

Mikey is here often then?

HOSTESS

All the time. All the time. We are close to naming a sandwich after him!

MIKA

(To Nona) If Mikey were to be a luncheon meat what would he be. Pastrami? Roast Beef? Possibly Bologna.

Mikey sipping coffee overhears the end of the listing of meats.

MIKEY

Bologna? It's great here. The fried Bologna sandwich. Purrrr-fect. They use that thick Bologna, the inch thick type.

WAITRESS

Oh yes it is. Really good sandwich.

MIKA

You are our waitress, yes? I need one thing, coffee.

WAITRESS

Oh. Oh no, no. I was just talking with Mikey, my boyfriend and I are thinking of getting a house.

MIKA

Really. That is great. And Mikey gives good advice, no?

WAITRESS

The best. The best! Didn't know what we could afford until Mikey ran the numbers. Hell, I didn't even know what a mortgage was really!

Waitress motions she needs to get going.

MIKA

Oh yes. Mikey is terrific at numbers, knows the sweet spots. I need to ask you, is she engaged to the boyfriend?

MIKEY

Hmmmm?

MIKA

The waitress, is she engaged?

MIKEY

Oh no, no I don't think so.

MIKA

So how will that work then, the mortgage? How? If not engaged? Then who owns the house.

MIKEY

Oh, that's easy.

MIKA

But how.

MIKEY

Let me explain -

NONA

OK, sit. You can annoy Mikey and whatever waitress you like after we talk.

Mikey smiles.

MIKA

So, Nona is here. Mika is here.  
Who is our waitress - hmmm - is it  
Mara over there? Whatever. We are  
all here. What do you want to talk  
about? What?

MIKEY

Well, the house.

MIKA

No shit! Really? I tell her you  
have to get at least 280 for it now.  
I'm now convinced, higher price is  
the way to go!

Mikey ignores while finishing eggs Benedict.

MIKEY

I think ... I think I have another  
buyer.

MIA

Really, you have another buyer? Who  
- no we don't need to know - what is  
the offer. What is the amount.

MIKEY

The good thing is, you know the  
person making the offer.

MIKA

Marjean again? Yes, we know her  
Mikey.

MIKEY

No, no someone different. Someone  
you will like.

NONA

Listen to him. Just listen.

Mika beginning to realize situation.

MIKA

Oh shit.

WAITRESS

What can I get for you all? Start  
off with drinks?

MIKA

Evidently, he has started with the  
entire meal already. He clearly  
understands the social rules.



MIKEY

No no - I am going to get the Danish. The danish here is huge, it's a meal onto itself. You gotta see it. It fills an entire plate.

NONA

I know! I have seen them but have never gotten it.

MIKEY

Oh, you gotta have it Nona. You gotta have it. You can try the first bite.

NONA

I know what I want. Egg white omelet, bacon on the side, coffee. Please!

MIKA

Oh, come on. Just two eggs. Flipped. The flipped ones.

MIKEY

He means over easy.

MIKA

Flipped, over easy, sunny side down. All the same. How many people say flipped? How many?

The waitress thinks. Her name is Mara from the tag.

MIKA

Mara, how many.

MARA

A few ... most say over easy. But I get what you want!

MIKA

Great. Flipped. Two. Rye bread. NO BUTTER on it. None. No butter. Please. Coffee. And how much is the orange juice. Fresh squeezed, no?

MARA

A cup is \$3.75.

MIKA

Uh - no then.

MIKEY

No, no, no, he'll get it. I am  
(MORE)

MIKEY (CONT'D)  
 paying. I am paying. Get the  
 juice, it's good. In fact, I'll  
 take one too.

MIKA  
 Are you playing in a hockey  
 tournament after this? OJ, Danish,  
 that's a lot of carbs.

MARA  
 Oh Mikey, thanks for the time share  
 idea.

MIKA  
 What? What time share? Mikey, you  
 never told us about timeshares!

MARA  
 The time share I have in Las Vegas.

MIKA  
 You have a time share in Las Vegas?

Mara nods - points to Mikey.

MARA  
 Yeah, he explained how it worked.  
 It's a good investment.

MIKA  
 I am so sorry. Mara, I am Mika. And  
 you know Mikey. So he convinced  
 you, he had logic that made sense?

MARA  
 Absolutely, I now own a time share!  
 It's going up right behind the  
 Flamingo! I am buying it with my  
 boyfriend.

MIKEY  
 Location, location, location!

MIKEY  
 Beautiful. Mara, thank you.

Mara is off. Mika buries head in hands.

MIKEY  
 I know what is happening here. I  
 know. Should have known. Should  
 have seen this one.

NONA  
 What?

MIKA  
Eatery. Public eatery.

MIKA  
Huh?

MIKA  
Public place. You and Nona clearly know who the buyer is. Take me to public place, pitch idea, I cannot get mad because (points around) public place.

Nona smiling.

NONA  
Oh, we just wanted a good lunch.

MIKA  
The only thing, who is the buyer. Who. Whoever could it be.

MIKEY  
Ahhh yes, so back to the buyer. You know her. Irinia Polovich.

Mika smiles, then laughs.

MIKA  
One more time, please.

MIKEY  
Irinia. Irinia Polovich. She is -

MIKA  
I know who she is. I know.

Mika looks down and says the following. In a louder voice.

MIKA  
OK, in this moment I am safe. But I am permitted one irrational moment. One, just one. I am safe but I get one. How the FUCK is an unwed, soon-to-be mother of two from two different gentlemen going to buy a house for over 300. Note, I know the parents, who are very nice indeed, they are not independently wealthy. How the fuck is she going to pay that price.

PATRON  
Hey! Language!

Mika looks up, smiles, looks to patron.

MIKA

Hey, I am sorry! I am safe here.  
From this point forward I choose  
peace over fear. If you knew what  
was going on here - you would be on  
my side.

Mika looks back to Nona and Mikey, and speaks calmly.

MIKA

OK, how. How is she going to pay?  
What is she - she works as a  
receptionist at an ear, nose, and  
throat doctor? How? Come on. Is  
the latest guy loaded?

Mikey laughs and he puts sugar in his coffee. Mara also  
serves Nona and Mika theirs.

MIKEY

I wish! Hardly. But she is doing a  
joint mortgage with Martin.

Mika thanks the waitress.

MIKA

Thank you. Who? Who is Martin?

NONA

Martin. Martin the boyfriend.  
Husband to the child - we talked  
about him before the baby shower.

MIKA

Oh yes, we did! And again. Come on!  
But I am not unshaken as I say  
this. How can they get a mortgage?  
They are not even married.

MIKEY

It's 2026. There's no morality  
clause when you apply for a  
mortgage. Just names and a credit  
history!

MIKA

Thank you. Thank you. I realize  
it's 2026. We might forget what day  
it is, but we remember the years.  
But how can they get a mortgage?  
Like in two months - this guy could  
be onto a new woman. Move to  
Memphis to take up work as a  
carpenter or whatever with his new  
girlfriend, see the kid once a year  
when he is back in town to visit.

The patron looks at Mika and shakes her head in complete disgust.

PATRON

I never.

Mika looks out the window.

NONA

No, not Martin. He would not do that. He is a good guy! He is. And he does tile work, by the way.

Mika calms and becomes contemplative.

MIKA

Ya know, I think, in Scandinavia, I think Sweden, it's rather common for the man and woman to have a family but not formally get married. Ever. I think. Did I see that on the PBS? I forget where. They must have a name for it, like a nice name. Not common law or whatever we call it here. So, they are that then. OK. Whatever the Swedes call it.

Mika then pulls out his phone.

MIKEY

Well ... whatever the case, they qualified for a \$210K mortgage. Jointly. They got approved on Friday.

Mika keeps looking at phone.

NONA

Mika, what are you doing?

MIKA

It is. It is a thing. Actually, it's quite common! It's called sambo. What a name. Oh this is great. Great. In Sweden. When the man and woman are not married but are romantically involved, start a family. It's quite common. There laws for it and everything. So, I was wrong. Irinia and Martin are not common law, they are sambo. It's very Scandinavian.

NONA

Yes, very Scandinavian. Forward thinking.

Mika looks up.

MIKA

OK - so - we are done right? You (points to Mikey) need it to be at least 240 K - house is definitely worth that. They can only pony up 210 K. So, end of discussion. Right. Right? Nona, you do not know this but he needs the house to sell for at least 240 or he can't drive that BMW anymore..

Mika looks at them both. Nona and Mikey are silent.

MIKA

But ... you do know that. Oh fuck. That wasn't the bad part. Not even the bad part!

PATRON

Hey!

MIKA

Sorry, sorry! I am calm and centered. I am at peace with what is happening. I am not this stress, I am it's awareness.

Mika then thinks speaking to no one impartial.

MIKA

But what ... what is the idea? I still do not understand.

NONA

They don't have to make up the difference. We give it with the commission.

She sips her coffee.

MIKA

What? What does that mean?

NONA

We increase the percentage that Mikey gets to get him to the percentage he would get at 240 K.

MIKA

So ... we get less. We only get ... Nona if I do the math we only get 184 K profit. And we give a commission at a rate as though it were 240 K even though it sells for 210. Are we crazy.

NONA

Yes on the price. No on the 'crazy' part.

MIKEY

Yes! Exactly!

MIKA

And this sells the house. Right?  
This sells the house. Right?  
Bullet proof sale.

NONA

Yes.

MIKA

Why do we do this? You realize - we had an offer. An actual offer for 280 K. A great offer. And now we lose 70 K - more than that with this commission nonsense. Why do we do this? No - no. No, just reduce the price to 250 and sell it that way. It will sell.

NONA

We are doing this because we are kind people. Because we help people. Mikey needs the sale. Irinia needs the house. A big house with children in the space. They need room. And we can do this.

MIKA

Then why not list it at 250 K and Irinia can go to her momma and papa and ask for the money.

NONA

No, not. We will not do this. You know they cannot help.

MIKEY

And 200 K is still a great price. For that amount I know many timeshares in Ft. Lauderdale right on the water.

MIKA

You - you. We are not getting a fucking timeshare. I know where that leads. I hear the commercials 'Do you own a timeshare and want to get out.' No, no!

Mikey shrugs and goes backs to eating.

MIKEY

They are not that bad. It's almost like playing cards when you have a bunch of them. It's fun! It gives you so many options of where to go ...

MIKA

Yes, just like bridge or pinochle. Great. So ... we are out over 90 K. And Irinia and ... Martin, is it Martin? They get a house.

NONA

Exactly!

MIKA

Well, this is your house. Your money. You can do what you want. I am at peace. But - can I say one thing. Just one?

NONA

Yes. One.

Mika points to Mikey

MIKA

This, this is your fault. Your fault! I tell you the house should have been lower. Lower! We could have set the initial price at 250, gotten offer and been out of this deal. Out. Even if it sold for 235 that is a lot more money!

NONA

Well, water under the bridge.

MIKA

Yes, under the bridge.

MIKEY

Well, this is great news. I am glad we have resolution! Really glad. Let's talk next steps.

MIKA

Yes, resolution. The next steps are - they close. Just find a closing date. Find a closing date.

Waitress arrives with the food. She places in front of Nona and Mika

MARA

OK, eggs, over easy. Or flipped.



MIKA

Thank you.

MARA

And an egg white omelet. Which is a great choice. This one is my favorite! Not enough people order it in my opinion. And a Danish.

NONA

Thank you!

MIKA

Mara, one thing. Just, quickly before I forget. You have so many people to take care of.

MARA

Sure. Sure!

MIKA

I cannot help but remember. You said you bought the timeshare with your boyfriend. This is a very European thing to do. I am from Europe, as you can tell. Buying a house with your partner, starting a family, maybe, I do know your situation of course. But doing that. It reminded me of Europe. In fact, in Sweden, Sweden, it is called sambo when you are not married but get a house and start a life with the person you love. I like it, I think it is great.

Mara smiles. Turns to face Mika.

MARA

Thank you. Thank you! My mother thinks I'm crazy to do this. But, it's not. It's like, refined. European. What is it called?

MIKA

Sambo. Sambo. Just, ask ChatGPT. Very European. It reminded of being in the old country.

MARA

I am going to tell my mother this. Again, thank you! It's right behind the Flamingo too!

Mara walks away.

NONA  
You are an asshole.

MIKA  
I am just making people happy. I  
like to spread joy. I am supported  
by the wisdom of the universe.

Mikey looks to ask Mika a question.

Shakes his head and dives into the Danish.

MIKEY  
Oh, Nona you have to try it.

INT. LIBRARY.

MIKA sits at a seat reading the New York Times.

Across from him a petite older woman impeccably dressed  
pages through a New Yorker.

Mika's phone rings.

MIKA  
Yes. What is it.

NONA  
Are you at the library?

MIKA  
Yes, you know that I am.

NONA  
OK, I thought you would be. I have  
good news.

MIKA  
Martina and Irinia cannot buy the  
house.

The older woman looks and shakes head.

Mika waves her off as he gets up to go outside.

NONA  
No, no, not that. Not at all.  
Rather, we have a dinner party.

MIKA  
I thought you said this was good  
news.

NONA  
With Martin and Irinia.

Mika is silent.

NONA

Hello?

MIKA

Waiting. I am waiting for the good news.

NONA

Come on. This is a good thing! We can see them, and she wants us to meet Susanna.

MIKA

Why must we have dinner with them? Can't we just sell them the house? Why not do it after they have the house.

NONA

No, no. That is a house warming party. That will happen too!

MIKA

We are not getting them a gift for that. We are not.

NONA

Yes, we are! We are. It's on Tuesday.

MIKA

Choice?

NONA

None. You are going.

MIKA

OK, we are going. At least the child has a decent name. She must be close to having the other child.

NONA

She is eight months. Eight.

MIKA

This new baby is not going to interfere with the closing?

NONA

I need to you pick-up a champagne on the way home.

MIKA

Oh come on, for the dinner on Tuesday? Really?

NONA

Yes, Chazs is open. I like that  
prosecco they had, the one with the  
blue label.

MIKA

But prosecco is not champagne, Nona.  
Is not champagne!

NONA

It is sparkling, that is all that  
matters. When will you leave the  
library?

MIKA

I don't know.

Mika peers into the window, the older woman is now talking  
with a friend.

MIKA

Like in a half hour. You know the  
dinner is not until Tuesday.

NONA

Just get the damn prosecco.

MIKA

OK, OK.

Mika hangs up and heads back in.

He goes to where the older woman sits and picks up the New  
Yorker from the table next to her.

OLDER WOMAN

Excuse me!

MIKA

What?

OLDER WOMAN

Excuse me! I am not done with that.

MIKA

It appears yes, you are. You are  
not reading it, you are having  
conversation.

OLDER WOMAN

I can do both. Thank you.

She reaches and grabs the magazine and goes back to  
talking. Mika points.

MIKA

Next week .... next week!

This time the older woman waves off Mika and goes back to her pleasant conversation.

INT. COFFEE SHOP

Mika sits with his friends and talks. A larger crowd.

He sips his coffee.

FRIEND 2

Wow. My first house ... in-laws lent us 10 K. My mother-in-law said it was a gift. Before all this shit got tracked by the government. Never heard the end of it. NEVER heard the end of it. Like everything went back to that 10 K - like 'Well we gave you the 10 thousand for the house.' Helped us avoid some mortgage insurance cost shit.

MIKA

Money mixed with family - never good.

FRIEND 2

Finally had enough. Enough. Like two years later I gave them back 5 K. And I thought for sure they would say 'Oh you don't have to do that!' Old man was sittin in his chair watching TV. Didn't even look up when I gave my mother-in-law the check. Just shouted 'When do we see the other 5 thousand. When.' Cheap ass bastard. His own daughter, no desire to help her out. I knew it was not a gift, I knew it.

FRIEND 1

Wow.

FRIEND 2

They brought it up all the time. Whenever we did anything that required a dime of money that asshole father would say 'You guys sure you can do that? You know, the house.' Worse thing I ever did was accept that 10 K..

FRIEND 1

Wait, why did you need just 10 K?

FRIEND 2

We didn't really. We had the money to cover everything. It just would have been like an extra \$100 a month 'mortgage insurance' because our downpayment was low. Some shit like that. So I said 'Yeah, we'll do this.' So stupid. It still burns me.

MIKA

Well, I have to give the money to Irinia and Martin and not complain. I simply have to give to them. Tonight I will see them for dinner.

FRIEND 1

Oh, that sounds like fun.

MIKA

The 'thank you' is when house is sold. I do not need a dinner. That will be the thank you, when I no longer have to worry about this stuff.

Philosopher is in other both. He chimes in.

PHILOSOPHER

Every experience, good or bad, evolves the soul.

MIKA

Oh ... oh ... thank you Randy. Thank you.

EXT. OF HOUSE

Nona and Mika knock on a front door.

Irinia opens the door.

In the background are Mikey and Martin.

Two teenage boys fight over a game console.

IRINIA

Mika, Nona! Come in! We are so glad you are here!

NONA

Irinia! You look amazing! One more month, one more month!

IRINIA

I know. I know! Susanna is so  
(MORE)

IRINIA (CONT'D)  
 excited. She keeps asking when she is going to have a baby sister. One month! Probably earlier, I can just feel it. And Mika, thank you so much with the house! I heard all that you did. I know what you did. Truly. Thank you!

Mika is actually taken aback.

MIKA  
 Hello Irinia. And you, of course, are welcome. And Mikey - why are you here?

IRINIA  
 Mikey wanted to be here to celebrate.

MIKA  
 Indeed, let us celebrate. Yes, celebrate.

IRINIA  
 Come, Nona, come on and look at the nursery vision board. Look at what we are planning. Martin looked at the bedroom pics. He wants to paint it this shade of pink, it is beautiful. How does he know? Come come.

MIKEY  
 Hi Mika! I want to see this vision board. This could be a thing - like to help market houses.

NONA  
 I have this cake, where should I put it?

IRINIA  
 In the kitchen. Right here. Martin, introduce yourself. Guests!

Martin sits on a couch watching TV.

A bowling tournament is on.

He simply turns and makes eye contact.

MARTIN  
 Heeeeey! Hey fella! Great to meet ya. Mika, right?

MIKA

Yes, Mika. It is good to meet you.

MARTIN

Hey, first, thank you for helping out with the house. Much appreciated.

Martin tips his beer to Mika.

MARTIN

Make yourself at home! There's beer in the fridge. You like bowling?

MIKA

Yes. I have not bowled in many years. But I like it.

MARTIN

Head on over to that fridge and grab a cold one. And then come on back and grab a seat. Tatum, get up, let Mika sit there. It's primo seating.

Tatum sulks away.

Mika heads to the kitchen.

From the background.

MARTIN

There is Miller Lite and Coors Lite. The Coors is for Irinia.

MIKA

Uh ... isn't she pregnant.

MARTIN

Exactly. That's why there's Coors Light. Hard liquors in the dining room if that's your poison..

Mika opens the fridge and pulls out a Miller Lite.

He opens the bottle and looks around.

There is no evidence of a dinner being prepared.

He returns to the living room.

MIKA

This is, quaint. It's nice.

MARTIN

Thanks! All Irinia. All Irinia. The decorations and most of the furniture.



MIKA

I do not see a dinner. Are we going out?

MARTIN

What? Oh, no, no. We ordered Chinese. I hope you like it. Everybody does.

MIKA

Yeah, sure.

MARTIN

We got it all. The General Tsaos. Sesame chicken. Some type of pork and broccoli stuff. Both types of the rice.

MIKA

That sounds splendid. Splendid.

MARTIN

Yeah, we do it like twice a week. There's a Chinese place off Brompton that's good. Avoid the one on Lajoie. Avoid! Right, Tatum.

Tatum plays his gaming console and gives his father the finger.

MARTIN

We think he got food poisoning there. We think.

MIKA

Yes, it's always hard to figure out where. I saw on the PBS that, you think it's the last thing you ate, but typically is not.

MARTIN

Yeah, for sure. For sure. The last thing you ate. We setup the dinner home style. So, you get what you want. Unless Tatum and Kenny want it, then it's a fight.

MIKA

Yep, a fight. So, I heard you look at pictures of the house. What did you think.

MARTIN

Oh, the ones online are great. Helped me visualize it a bunch. Figure out what to look at when we  
(MORE)

MARTIN (CONT'D)  
do the home inspection. It's a nice house, the layout is great but all the stuff is so outdated.

TATUM  
Like the pink bathroom.

MIKA  
You, you are Tatum, correct?

TATUM  
Yes I am .

MIKA  
Was very popular back in the 1970s. You choose pinks, browns, avocado green. Very popular.

Tatum looks at him like he has three heads.

TATUM  
It's 2026.

Mika thinks.

MIKA  
What home inspection happens later?

MARTIN  
Oh, for the house. Gotta have a home inspection. You know, you gotta protect yourself, know what you are getting into.

MIKA  
Of course, of course!

TATUM  
Dad, he's two blocks away.

MARTIN  
OK, OK.

TATUM  
Dad, two blocks. Well, almost one now.

MARTIN  
OK! I'll set the damn table!

Martin and Mika rise simultaneously.

MIKA  
Need to see what Nona is up to!

Mika wanders down hallway to another room.

It's the bedroom of Susanna.

There a large table is present and the the four, Nona, Mikey, Susanna, and Irinia sit or stand.

IRINIA

And that is where the rocking chair will go. Right there, by the window.

NONA

I always liked having it by the window. When I nursed I could look out the window. Then later the babies would always look at the leaves moved by the wind. It was nice. That is a good spot.

IRINIA

Oh you nursed too!

NONA

Yes, it was right at the point where they switched back from doing it to not doing it. And I need to tell you about these nut allergies and how to avoid the kids having them -

MIKA

Yes, great. Great. Nona, I need to ask you about the champagne, the food is on the way.

NONA

You just open it.

MIKA

Yes, but how.

Nona slowly looks to Mika as though he has lost his mind.

NONA

Its a cork. Pretty simple.

MIKA

But then what glasses.

IRINIA

Oh, there are champagne glasses by the microwave. I'll get them!

MIKEY

No, no, you point where and I will get them down! We can't have you doing anything unnecessary!

IRINIA

Frigging pregnancy - I can't drink.

NONA

Don't worry I made the cake! You can have that.

MIKA

What about the Coors?

Irinia rolls here eyes.

IRINIA

Those are for Martin's mom. He made that joke again, right?

Irinia, Susanna, and Mikey leave.

MIKEY

I think you can definitely use that shower as a tub. I think it has a lip on the front ....

NONA

They can certainly use that shower to wash the baby. I believe, no, I know my mom used to do that!

MIKA

Home inspection.

NONA

Yes, what about it.

MIKA

Home inspection?

NONA

What?

MIKA

Hello, they are going to have a home inspection!

NONA

Be quiet! Yes, they are. I knew about that.

MIKA

Are you crazy. Are we crazy! Home inspection! Do they realize the price they are getting this for!

Mikey reenters and senses the tension.

MIKEY

Whats going on?

MIKA  
Where is Irinia?

MIKEY  
Setting the table with Martin. He  
couldn't find -

MIKA  
He couldn't find anything if he  
needed to. We need to talk. What  
is this home inspection shit? Home  
inspection?

MIKEY  
Yeah, I told them to do it.

Mika looks disbelievingly at Mikey and Nona.

MIKA  
What? What!

MIKEY  
As their real estate agent I have a  
duty to ensure their best interest.

MIKA  
Oh great. Great. Of course. You  
are their agent as well so you have  
to do it. Right? Enough. Enough.

Mika then pulls back. Inhales and exhales. Holds up index  
finger.

MIKA  
I release what I cannot control.  
But ... one thing I do control. Not  
dime less. Not dime. I swear to  
you Mikey, if Martin and Irinia want  
more off, want repairs, deal is off.

NONA  
The deal won't be off. Let them do  
the inspection. It's a good think.  
Mikey - they even have a swatch for  
the curtains look.

MIKEY  
Oh wow, they got that at the Hobby  
Lobby, right? Oh, forest animals!

MIKA  
I mean it, if they come back with  
requests, deal is off. Nona, is  
off, understood?

MIKEY

Of course, of course, I will talk to them.

Mika looks at the vision space.

MIKA

It actually looks nice. I might try to update something else, first. But nursery is important.

MIKEY

The most important! I spent weeks getting ours into shape. Owen and Fisher used the same one. Fisher did not like having to leave. We had to tell him that his baby brother needed it. Oh the crying, it went on for days! One morning we found him back in the nursery sleeping on the floor.

MIKA

Yes, such difficulties.

TEN MINUTES PASS BY

All are around the dining room table, finishing the Chinese food.

MARTIN

I do tile work. I started out in general construction but, the tile stuff suited me. I was - I am - good at it.

MIKA

Yes, tile work. Is certainly needed for the pink tiles. No?

MARTIN

Oh yeah, those will be the first things to go. I can knock that out in like a week. I need to poke around tomorrow and see what else is up. Sometimes it's all rotten behind the tiles. So, you have to replace all the dry wall.

The children dive in for more Chinese.

It is clear the family is eating off of Chinet type plates.

MIKA

Oh - tomorrow? What happens tomorrow?

MARTIN

The home inspection. At 3PM.

NONA

Susanna, you can choose the bedroom you want. Mine was the one on the corner. I liked it because it had windows facing two ways. I would recommend that.

MARTIN

Oh, that's a whole thing! Kids want to see it and then probably fight over it.

IRINIA

I think Susanna will get her choice. Ladies first..

Mika looks in amazement.

MIKA

The home inspection is ... tomorrow?

MARTIN

Oh yeah, it works for my schedule. I have a job in Eaton - I can get it done by 1PM and then swing over to the house.

MIKA

Good, good. I will be there too!

MIKEY

Oh ... you don't have to go. I can take care of it! Technically, the homeowner should not be there for the inspection.

MIKA

Nonsense, we are family. I know a lot about the house. I can answer questions. Point out things. And also, technically, agent should not represent both. Irinia and Martin should have their own agent to advocate.

MIKEY

Its fine, it's fine! You should be there.

MARTIN

I'd like that, actually! I'd like that if you were there. Always good to have someone who can explain stuff.

MIKA  
Absolutely.

NONA  
Well, let us clear and bring in the cake!

As Nona gets up so does Mika.

MIKA  
Yes, let us help you and clear.  
Martin, you were right, you would never know these plates are disposable.

MARTIN  
Ain't it something! It's like ... it looks exactly like real plates. Just like my moms. It's so neat. Hey - is that coffee ready? That cake looks tremendous too!

EXT. TAN BRICK HOUSE

MIKA and MIKEY stand by Mikey's BMW.

Two cups of Dunkin Donuts coffee sit on top of the roof.

Mikey looks at phone.

MIKEY  
You know anyone interested in a condo? Two bedrooms, 1.5 baths.

MIKA  
Where?

MIKEY  
Kensington and Brayson.

MIKA  
No, I don't. Most of the people I know are more concerned with a smaller plot of real estate. Your listing?

MIKEY  
Yeah, Brian just gave it to me. After I got this one on the books, he fed me this condo. Is that a chaise sofa? Is that what they call those things?

MIKA  
That is great. So happy this house is leading to so many good things for you.



A pickup truck pulls up. Out steps MARTIN.

The two snot nosed sons exit and immediately tear into the house at top speed.

IRINIA piles out of the truck, though laboriously. Susanna comes to her mother's help.

MARTIN

I'll tell you the first problem.  
That roof. I know roofs. It's not  
long for the world.

IRINIA

Oh. That doesn't sound good. How  
much will it cost.

MARTIN

Oh ... 20 thousand at least.  
Probably. I thought it might not be  
good from the pictures. Yeah, it's  
got maybe one ... two years left.

Mika exasperated goes to speak to Mikey.

But Mikey addresses Martin and Irinia first..

MIKEY

OK, walk the exterior first! Note  
anything you have a problem with!  
Note it all!

Irinia and Martin wave and start their walk of the outside.

MIKA

What the - Mikey - what the hell are  
you saying?

MIKEY

Mika, I have a duty to represent  
the folks. Just know that whatever  
they identify, we'll have to deal  
with it.

MIKA

Jesus Christ. Yes, deal with it.  
Where the hell did those animal kids  
go?

MIKEY

Oh, they went in the house with  
Irinia.

MIKA

Mikey - Irinia is right there.  
Those fucking kids ...

Mika storms off to the house. Shouts to Mikey.

MIKA  
What are their names? Children?  
Names?

MIKEY  
Oh, Tatum and Ken! Great kids!  
Probably figuring out which bedroom  
to take. Amazing kids. The one is  
in Fisher's travel league, he has  
real -

Mika simply turns and heads into the house.

Irinia and Martin look at a white plumbing pipe coming out  
of the ground.

Mika shouts over.

MIKA  
Its a bubbler system. For drainage!

MARTIN  
I know! Why would they have a clean  
out here? Any ideas?

Mika ignores the question and heads into the house.

Tatum is pressing the ice dispenser and watches as cubes  
fall to the ground.

From the living room another sound is heard.

MIKA  
You, you, I know you. Tatum right?

TATUM  
Yeah, why?

MIKA  
Get out of house and to your father  
you go. Now! Stay with your family  
the entire time you are here. GET  
OUT!

Tatum presses the ice cube dispenser one more time and  
then leaves.

TATUM  
Can you clean that up!

Mika then heads to the living room.

The child is by the fireplace, poker in hand.

He is smashing at a grill trying to pry it off.

MIKA

Hey, stop! Why you do that! Stop now!

KENNETH

Why?

MIKA

Why? WHY! Because I fucking said said so. Why you do that!

KENNETH

Because this is our house and I don't like this.

MIKA

Your house ... your house! I own this house. I own it.

KENNETH

It's ours!

Mika walks to him and gets within inches of his face.

MIKA

Get out now. Now. Or I'll wrap that goddamn poker round your neck.

Mika grabs poker out of the boys hand.

Kenneth runs out of the house screaming.

As he leaves the house Mika sees the two boys are in the backyard messing in the bushes.

IRINIA

Oh, sorry Mika! Sorry. Boys ... don't worry they'll stay with us.

MIKA

Oh, I understand! I understand! Had two boys. Just making sure they were safe in there.

MARTIN

I saw that stair case and the railing! Tell me our guys are going to turn that into some rock climbing thing!

MIKA

Yep. Sports. I am to going to wait in the garden! Enjoy the walk through!

Mika heads to the garden area.

There, the boys push down bushes to get to the fence.

MIKA

You two, get out of here. Stay outside. Go in with parents ONLY to the house. Parents ONLY!

The boys rush off while Mika sits in the garden area.

His phone rings.

MIKA

Hi Nona.

NONA

Hi, how is it going?

MIKA

Oh, he is saying things that need be fixed. Whatever. They have such lovely boys!

NONA

I know! I just love the idea of children in that house again! My mom would have loved it.

MIKA

I am in the garden. In the back. It's beautiful. It really is. With weed tarp and perennials - is very nice.

NONA

I know. I know. Mom loved to sit back there.

MIKA

She would sit back here by the hour. And listen to those CDs. Who was it? Who - the one she liked best?

NONA

What?

MIKA

The CD, the CD player. The disks she really liked. Remember?

NONA

Oh, yes, Miss Judy. Miss Judy. Judy Collins. Yes, she loved her very much.

MIKA

You know, I liked coming to your  
(MORE)

MIKA (CONT'D)  
mother's house. Very much. My  
parent's house, just OK. But I  
liked it here.

NONA  
I did too. Be sure to do one thing.  
There are small flower pots close  
to the fence. They have rosemary.  
Take those for me.

MIKA  
Yes, of course.

Mika collects the pots and continues to sit.

TWENTY MINUTES LATER

Mika walks back.

He stands behind Mika but does not face him.

MIKEY  
So, they liked the house. Only a  
few things. Just minor.

MIKA  
House is old. There will be things  
of course.

MIKEY  
So, the roof is not good. We went  
in the attic and -

MIKA  
Stop. I know what they want. And  
thinking, house at 210 K still need  
renovations. If they look, they  
will say, needs furnace, needs roof,  
needs kitchen Needs ... everything.  
So much work. But you know, I  
know, 210 K it is worth every penny.  
So I will tell you, what do you get  
for free in life? Little. Nothing.  
Here is what they get for free -  
including the 70 thousand because  
you decided to read a letter. Get 5  
thousand more off. Is furnace, is  
stove, is something, not nothing.  
New price is 205 K.

MIKEY  
That's perfect. They wanted at  
least 10 - half way point. Mika,  
you could be a real estate agent.

MIKA  
Yes, of course.

Mikey walks off with the news for Irinia and Martin.

Mika calls Nona.

MIKA  
Good news, I did something nice.  
Kind. Deal will close, Mikey makes  
commission, Irinia gets a house.

NONA  
Oh, that is wonderful! Oh that is  
great. See, Mika, you did a good  
job. Let me talk with Mikey.

MIKEY  
He will be here in a minute. He is  
talking with them. Do you need me  
to pick up anything on the way home?  
I think we are out of pickles. For  
the sandwiches.

NONA  
Yes pickles, and some type of pasta.  
Whatever you think is best.

Mikey is back.

MIKEY  
Smooth deal done! Done!

MIKA  
Great. Nona wants to talk.

Mika hands phone over the shoulder. Mikey and Nona talk.

MIKEY  
Yeah, it's great! Oh the kids loved  
it.

While they talk Mika looks at coffee and garden itself.

INT. COFFEE SHOP

MIKA in line.

MIKA  
One cream. One cream! Every day  
it's the same. The same! You have  
been, Robert, you have been working  
here since August of last year.  
Every day I order the same thing,  
small coffee with one cream. How  
(MORE)

MIKA (CONT'D)  
can you not remember that? Do you  
not know me, remember me?

Robert gives a blank stare, somewhat stunned.

MIKA  
Come on, I give the exact change  
pretty much everyday. That way I  
know when you are screwing us on the  
prices.

MANAGER  
I'll talk to him Mika. We know,  
it's one cream.

MIKA  
Samantha, come on! Has been here 9  
months and does not know me? Every  
day?

Samantha makes the coffee.

SAMANTHA/MANAGER  
I know, I know.

Samantha and Mika speak only to each other.

MIKA  
Sam, you worry about the future when  
you see kids like this? Sam? Do  
you?

SAMANTHA  
I do. I do to.

Sam then looks perplexed at Robert as he is confused at a  
customer request.

SAMANTHA  
Robert - a half dozen means six. It  
means six. (under her breath)  
Goddammit. I'm coming ...

Sam storms over to the donut case.

Mika heads to his friends.

Rubs hands together a la LeBron James.

MIKA  
Its closing day. Closing day!

FRIEND 1  
Oh, nice. Finally.

FRIEND 2

Yeah, finally we can stop hearing about this shit.

MIKA

Oh come on, you like! Magical day, closes at 1PM. Call from attorney. Check in bank. Done with house. Done with Mikey, Irinia, all of it.

FRIEND 2

Took goddamn long enough. This guy - he was able to RV coast to coast. Like coast to coast in the time it took you to close on this house.

MIKA

How was it?

FRIEND 3

Oh it was amazing. Amazing. RV'd on route 66. Stayed at military bases when I could or KOA. The highlight - Grand Canyon. That thing is huge.

FRIEND 2

Really, I never knew!

MIKA

Did you have a car? Did you trailer a car?

FRIEND 3

Oh yeah. The Bronco. Put that sucker on it and towed all the way from St. Louis to Los Angeles. Oh, best trip ever.

FRIEND 1

How do you do it? I mean, I would be terrified to change lanes with it. Can you even see it?

FRIEND 3

They have a camera mount so ... you can sort of see whats going on. But we were in Arizona, and, it was like clear behind me to merge, so I do. But this guy in the outer lane merges and the same time. The EXACT same time. I nearly took him out.

FRIEND 1

You give way?



FRIEND 3

Hello no! He goes crazy and starts laying on the horn. My wife was like 'Oh my God we are going to hit him.' Yeah, backed down.

FRIEND 1

Nice!

MIKA

I could not imagine being in RV with Nona for ... weeks. I would not want to imagine it.

Mika looks at phone while friends talk about trip.

It is a call from MIKEY

MIKA

Hey, how are you.

MIKEY

Good. I think. I'm here.

MIKA

Where at the closing? At the clerks office? That's not for another two hours.

MIKEY

No, I'm here.

MIKA

WHERE!

MIKEY

At the coffee shop.

MIKA

Why the hell are you here? Just focus on the closing. Where are you?

MIKEY

Out front. Nona said you would be here. We need to talk about the closing ... it might not happen.

MIKA

Might not happen? Might?

MIKEY

Probably won't happen.

Mika hangs up phone.

Agitated he rises and makes contact with Mikey outside.

Mikey sees Mika smiles and waves.

MIKA

That. That is Mikey. I need to talk with him.

The friends look.

Two of them wave and Mikey waves back.

FRIEND 2

Mikey! There's the BMW. Mika, it looks like a fine car.

MIKA

Is a lease. Is not his car. I need to talk to him.

Mika storms outside while the friends continue to talk,.

FRIEND 3

Went to a really neat National Park near Santa Fe, Bandelier, that was a beautiful park.

FRIEND 2

Santa Fe, is that where Gene Hackman died?

FRIEND 1

Hackman. Hoosiers. Now there's a movie. I had my son watch it to understand how to prepare for games. Mentally.

Mika and Mikey enter.

MIKA

I have to call Nona. Guys, this is Mikey. Talk.

FRIENDS IN TOTO

Hey Mikey! Mikey! We have heard so much about you!

MIKEY

Oh that is great! Hey, I am real estate agent. Let me give you my card -

MIKA

They know who you are. Any real estate needs - I direct them to you. Hello, Nona? I need your advice. No - everything is OK. Just listen.

FRIEND 3

What happened?

Mikey sits with the others.

MIKEY

Well, it's Martin. Do you guys know Martin?

FRIEND 2

Yeah, the dude buying the house.

MIKEY

Ahh, so you do know Martin. How much has Mika told you?

FRIEND 1

Ya know, like everything.

MIKEY

Oh great! Well, Martin was working a job last night. And he was framing in a closet.

Mika chimes in from talking with Nona.

MIKA

He lays tile! Idiot was doing a side job! No, no, Mikey is here, I just ... I needed to say that, there was inaccuracy ...

MIKEY

He was working with a oscillating saw cutting dry wall ... and cut his finger pretty badly. I had to Google oscillating saw - I had no clue what it was..

FRIEND 2

How bad. He lost a finger or something?

MIKEY

No, no, he lost a fingernail. Well, is probably going to lose a fingernail.

FRIEND 3

Fingernail? Like it got smashed?

MIKEY

No, it got cut off. It got sliced off. Partially

FRIEND 3

Oh come on, no way man.

MIKEY

Oh he did, it's bad. It's bad! He  
Tik Tok'd after it happened. Look -

Mikey shows his phone to the friends. All look in disgust.

FRIENDS IN TOTO

Oh come on, why did you have to show  
us that! Come on man.

MIKEY

Well, they were able to stitch the  
fingernail cap back on. But he's  
definitely going to lose the nail.  
I think it's 28 stitches.

FRIEND 2

Fingernail cap?

MIKEY

That's what Irinia called it. The  
cap.

Mika is done talking with Nona.

MIKA

Mikey, stop talking to them. Look  
at me. Nona is still OK to watch  
Susanna when she gets off bus. And  
she can take care of Angela as well.  
So, what is problem. This is  
unfortunate, but we can still close.

MIKEY

So, we need him at the closing. We  
need him.

MIKA

You need him physically there?

MIKEY

Yes, his name is on the mortgage -  
he has to be there. In person.

MIKA

So we take him. Hell, I go to. We  
take him. He just signs with an X -  
who cares. Why is this a big deal?

MIKEY

Irinia. Irinia. She says he can't  
go. He is out of it. He is on  
medication and is sluggish, won't  
get out of bed.

MIKA

So, just do the closing tomorrow then.

MIKEY

It doesn't work that way. We have to get back on the master schedule.

MIKA

So ...

MIKEY

So, we wait another three weeks.

MIKA

Fuck no. It happens today then!

MIKEY

And if we miss today, the mortgage offer might expire during that time and he has to reapply for the mort--

MIKA

Stop. Stop, stop, stop. It happens. Why do you people drag me into this shit.

MIKEY

We didn't plan to do this.

MIKA

Let's go to Irinia's. Nona will be there in the hour.

FRIEND 3

Can we go to? We are committed to this thing!

Mika shakes his head at them.

Mika starts to head to door.

Mikey proceeds into the line of customers.

MIKA

Mikey, now! We go NOW. What are you doing?

MIKEY

I'm getting ... I need. I need breakfast.

MIKA

What? What, are you crazy let's go?

MIKEY

You don't understand, without  
breakfast I am not functioning well.  
Um ...

ROBERT

White, wheat, or rye.

MIKEY

Is the rye seeded?

ROBERT

Is the rye what?

MIKEY

Seeded?

ROBERT

What?

MIKA

Oh Jesus Christ. Just give him the  
white. The white. You get white.  
Samantha, Sam!

SAM

What?

MIKA

Please, make sandwich for my friend.  
We are in rush. And he ... must  
eat.

Mika says this to Robert.

MIKA

Robert, you are great kid, bound for  
great things. You take a century to  
make sandwich. To get coffee. To do  
anything!

SAM

I will make it. Calm down. Calm  
down!

To Mikey

SAM

What type of bread do you want?

INT. OF BMW

Mikey is driving and holding sandwich.

Mika sits in the passenger seat looking out window.

MIKEY

I wish I would have known if it were seeded or not. Ya know, I like a seeded rye.

Mika says sarcastically.

MIKA

Oh, don't worry. It was not seeded. Not seeded. Hopefully the wheat would not be choice two.

MIKEY

It could have been, in the moment.

MIKA

Where is your phone?

MIKEY

Why?

MIKA

I call Irinia. Have to call her. To reassure her it will be OK.

MIKEY

It's here. Here. Wait, let me just voice call her. Siri, call Irinia.

Phone rings.

IRINIA

Hello. Mikey?

Mika speaks soothingly.

MIKA

Nina, it's Mika, I am with Mikey. How is Martin. Terrible thing that happened, how is he?

IRINIA

Oh Mika, Mika, not good. Not good. He slept all night but now he's just moaning in bed.

MIKEY

So, do you think he might be - I don't know - better - a little better by noon for the closing?

IRINIA

Oh Mikey, Mika, I don't know. I think we have to cancel the closing - right? I don't know - can we do it?

MIKEY

Well, I can bring you there. And  
Mika is here to help to. We can  
take the beamer.

MIKA

And Nona will still watch Angela and  
Susanna when she is off the bus. By  
the way, I love the baby's name. I  
truly do.

IRINIA

Oh thank you. Thank you! It was  
Martin's grandmothers name. I wish  
he hadn't done this. I told him to  
just stay home. But he's trying to  
do all these side jobs because he's  
worried about the mortgage.

MIKA

Yeah well, he's got 30 years to  
worry about it. Look, Irinia, I  
know it seems like he can't do it.  
But with us there, with Nona, we can  
make this work.

MIKEY

Yeah, and if we cancel it's like  
another three months before we can  
close.

IRINIA

WHAT!

MIKEY

Three months.

IRINIA

Our lease is up in four weeks! We  
have not place to go.

MIKEY

I'm sure Mika and -

MIKA

No, no, we won't! We won't because  
we can do this. Right. Team work.  
Make dream work.

IRINIA

OK, just get over and we'll figure  
it out. MARTIN!

Irinia hangs up.

Mikey does an exaggerated exhale.



MIKA

Go to my house. Let's get Nona.

MIKEY

I thought she was going to drive to Martin's?

MIKA

No, no. Too many ... uh variables.  
Lets pick her up. Is on the way.

Mikey says this out loud.

MIKEY

Siri, call Cynthia.

MIKA

Who is that?

MIKEY

Cynthia? Cynthia the attorney. The one doing the closing.

Phone rings. Mika grabs phone and hangs up.

MIKEY

What are you doing?

MIKA

Why call? What reason?

MIKEY

To let her know the closing might not go happen.

MIKA

No, no no no no no! No call.  
Are you crazy, just tell no one!  
Let's get everyone to clerks office and figure out. You tell this Lana it might not happen and red flags everywhere. Have you actually sold a house?

Mikey motions to the BMW.

MIKEY

Hello, yes!

MIKA

You, you should get into politics.  
As long as people like you, which people do like you, you can be as stupid as you want and succeed.

Mikey pulls into Mika's driveway. Nona is waiting.

MIKEY

Oh look, Nona is ready.

MIKA

Yes, genius. I text her. Whatever you do, whatever, just confidence. All well. You know, smooth deal.

NONA

Hi Mikey. How are you!

MIKEY

Oh Nona, great! Great! You look fantastic.

NONA

Oh Mikey, I like this car very much. This is very nice. The back seat is so roomy.

MIKEY

Oh thanks. You know, I thought of something a while back. If you are going to drive, you have to do it in style. We spend so much time in cars. You know, you spend -

MIKA

Yes, we know, like a 1/3 of you waking life in a car. Right?

MIKEY

Right! Can't go cheap.

NONA

Oh absolutely Mikey. I see the Land Rovers - I think I might want one.

MIKEY

Oh, I know the head salesman. I do! I really do. I helped him get a condo in Myrtle Beach. I think I could get it at cost - no commission.

NONA

Possibly, this is something to think about after the house closes.

MIKA

Great. Excellent. Please concentrate on driving. That was not a full stop at the stop sign.

NONA

I want to test drive one first.

MIKEY

Of course, you have to put yourself behind the wheel before you do anything. They even let you keep it overnight. I drove one for six months and loved it.

MIKA

Wait, why six? Lease is at least two years, why six.

MIKEY

How do you know I didn't buy it?

Mika looks at Mikey and shakes head.

MIKEY

It got totaled. Not my my fault -

FIVE MINUTES LATER

Mikey pulls into Irinia and Martin's driveway.

A large dog comes spiriting out of the back and barks at a side fence.

It is a Great Dane mix of some sort.

Mikey is finishing the totaled Land Rover story.

MIKEY

So, like I said - the construction work - the guy had never seen concrete barriers in the middle of the freeway before. They were using it as a diverter. I mean, his car was upside down, his daughter was crying on the side of the road.

NONA

This sounds terrible Mikey! I am glad you are OK.

MIKA

Whoa, who is that guy?

MIKEY

Oh, that's ... Romulus? I think? They got a dog. Once they got the house, they got a dog. Rescue dog.

MIKA

Let me understand, new baby in house, and they get a dog?

MIKEY

Yep.

MIKA

Actually, does not Marjean hate dogs.

NONA

Yes, this is good thing.

MIKA

OK, so, Nona, I mentioned that Martin have little injury on job. I may have to help him to car. No worries though.

Irinia comes out and sees them. She is in complete tears, though somewhat nicely dressed.

IRINIA

Oh Mikey, Mika. Nona! (Irinia forces a smile)

NONA

Oh baby, do not worry. Tell me what happened. Let's go check on baby.

MIKA

Wait, wait, wait, where is Martin? We need to check on him. Where is he?

IRINIA

Oh in the kid's bedroom. Tatum's. Didn't want him and the baby in the same room.

Mika and Mikey walk down the hallway to Tatum's room.

Before entering Mika looks to Mikey.

MIKA

OK, whatever happen, you do what I say. Do what I say! I fight in Afghan war and survive. I escape communist Russia. Listen to me. Listen!

Mika opens the door.

Martin is on bed.

Jeans, no shirt, face down, groaning.

MARTIN

Irinia, Irinia?

MIKA

No, not Irinia.

Martin rolls over.

MARTIN  
Ohhhh.... Irinia...Gatorade please.  
My mouth is so .... dry.

MIKA  
You want Gatorade? OK?

MARTIN  
Irinia .... ohhh ... Gatorade,  
please.

MIKEY  
I'll get some!

Mika then sees prescription, clearly Oxycontin.  
Take twice daily for five days. No refills.  
He opens the bottle to find five pills left.

MIKA  
5 ... 10 ... what the fuck.

MARTIN  
Irinia ... Gatorade.

Martin walks down the hallway. He has the pills and.  
Enters kitchen where Nona and Irinia talk.

NONA  
Shhh - baby is sleeping. Angela is  
so sweet! So sweet!

IRINIA  
I know! I know! Susanna was cute  
but there is something about Angela.

Mika holds up empty bottle.

MIKA  
Did he drink this today?

IRINIA  
Nah, that's his dip bottle.

MIKA  
Dip bottle.

IRINIA  
Nevermind. How is he?

MIKA  
Oh ... uh ... he is good coming out  
(MORE)

MIKA (CONT'D)  
of it. Hey ... these there were 10  
in here yesterday, correct?

IRINIA  
Probably, I dunno.

MIKA  
Who gives him these?

IRINIA  
I did last night. I gave him one  
last night.

MIKA  
But there are many missing.

IRINIA  
I dunno, he took it this morning.  
He said he was in pain, I said take  
the pills.

MIKA  
OK, just two a day.

Agitated with the questions Irinia responds.

IRINIA  
I KNOW! It's a controlled  
substance. Just two a day. Nona,  
look these pictures I took of Angela  
the other day. There is one, I  
swear, she knows she is getting her  
picture taken!

Mika heads back to bedroom.

There, Mikey is giving Martin the Gatorade bottle.

Mikey goes to Mika.

MIKEY  
Well, what do you think?

MIKA  
I think ... I think Martin should go  
to have stomach pumped based on  
number of pain killers he has taken.  
But, he can make it to the closing.

MARTIN  
Irinia ... do we have the Chex? The  
Corn Chex.

MIKEY  
Oh yeah, I saw those in the kitchen.  
(MORE)

MIKEY (CONT'D)

It's amazing how many flavors they have. Do you know in Canada they don't get as a big a selection. I was talking to a mom from Windsor at a tournament.

Mika grabs Mikey by the arms.

MIKA

Look at me. We are closing today. Will happen. Here is what we do. One, tell Irinia we drive Martin. We all drive together. Tell her he seems OK, seems fine. Say that BMW has plenty of room. Two, tell Irinia we will help them into the clerks office. Three, we stay for closing.

MIKEY

OK, sounds good. Hey chief, you ready for some Corn Chex. Let's get you dressed for the big day.

MARTIN

Irinia?

MIKA

You. You sell plan. People trust you. No clue why. Sell plan.

Mika heads kitchen.

FIVE MINUTES PASS

Mikey and Martin enter the kitchen.

Martin, amazingly, looks presentable, even his hair is combed.

MIKEY

This guy is ready, and wants some Chex.

MARTIN

Corn Chex ... strawberry ones. Gotta get us a house today.

Irinia enters with the large Great Dane.

IRINIA

This is Trooper. He is super friendly! Won't cause you any trouble Nona, he'll just stand at the door and lock eyes if he wants to go out.

Trooper is incredibly friendly and licks Nona's outstretched hand.

IRINIA

The food is over here. But he should be OK, let me feed him.

As Trooper scarfs down his food, Martin scarfs down his Chex.

MARTIN

Gonna get us a house today baby!

IRINIA

Exactly! Nona, do you know any good movers? I've already started packing.

NONA

OK, we can help with the packing and moving.

MIKA

Yes, we would love to.

Mika looks through the cereals.

IRINIA

Oh, do you want some cereal?

MIKA

Oh no, I have my coffee here. I just like to see what cereals people buy. Is fascinating, the diversity.

IRINIA

I'll tell you what, it's a lifesaver. Breakfast, lunch, and sometimes dinner in a box. Tatum and Kenny love the stuff. Really, they probably eat it two nights a week for dinner.

MIKA

Yes ... is great.

MARTIN

Hey Babe, we're getting a house today!

MIKA

Yes ... yes we are.

IRINIA

Let me show you a few more things for Angela before we go.



INT. BMW ON FREEWAY

Irinia is messing with all the controls and the interactive panel.

IRINIA  
What does this do?

MIKEY  
It controls the windows. See you can do it via the screen or this one controls everything.

IRINIA  
Oh!

MIKEY  
Let me show you a trick. Press the center all the way down and turn right.

All the windows come down.

IRINIA  
Oh that is great!

Mika is blasted with air in the back seat as is Martin.

MIKA  
Yes, is great on July day, parking lot, 95 degree temperatures. Less good on thruway at 65 miles and hour.

Irinia closes all windows.

Martin opens his again and sticks hand out to catch the air.

MARTIN  
Birds. Birds. Air flows over wings, learned in science class.

MIKA  
Yes, science.

MARTIN  
Ya know, in second grade we learned about the Pilgrims. Thanksgiving. Learned that too ... black cloths and the hats.

Martin looks out the window and his hand. Mika looks forward.

IRINIA

And I like this cup holder. It pops out of the console!

MIKEY

Oh Irinia, they thought of everything on this car. Everything!

IRINIA

I think I should get a BMW. You lease, right? I wanted to lease but my mom talked me out of it.

MIKEY

Oh, absolutely, absolutely! You have to lease. Leasing is the way to go. A new car every two years. It's fantastic.

MIKA

Yes, is great idea.

MIKEY

Mika, Mika! You are going to come around and see things my way! Same thing with the timeshares. You can take what you get for this house and instead of one condo, turn it into three timeshares. Go to all these different places! I'm telling you.

MIKA

Yes, yes. Is like card game. Great.

IRINIA

I like card games. They're fun.

MIKA

Well, timeshares are not like playing Go Fish.

Irinia turns to Mika.

IRINIA

I play more complicated games than Go Fish. Thank you.

She then turns back.

MARTIN

I like fish. The Swedish fish are the best. They have the multi color ones ... but those aren't the Swedish ones.

MIKA

You play complex games. Like what, solitaire?

IRINIA

Bridge, for one.

MIKA

Bridge? You? You play bridge?

IRINIA

Yes, yes I do, why is that surprising.

MIKA

There is no way, no way, you know how to play bridge.

Irinia gets irritated.

IRINIA

Yes, yes there are ways. I play very well thank you.

MIKA

Bridge? You? You play bridge?

IRINIA

Yes, yes I do. Again, why is that surprising?

MIKA

Okay. Then answer this. In bridge the seated positions are left, right, across, and self. True or false?

IRINIA

False. They're North, South, East, and West.

MIKA

Fine. Dealer is always South.

IRINIA

No. Dealer rotates clockwise after every hand.

MIKA

Lucky guess. Vulnerability changes every hand too, right?

IRINIA

Not every hand. It follows a board pattern. Sometimes nobody is vulnerable, sometimes both sides are.

MIKA

Hmm.

He studies her.

MIKA

What does a takeout double ask your partner to do?

IRINIA

Bid a suit. Usually their longest unbid suit. Unless they have some reason to pass.

MIKA

And if your partner opens one no-trump, what point range is that?

IRINIA

Depends on the system, but usually fifteen to seventeen.

MIKA

Interesting.

He leans forward.

MIKA

What would you open with this hand?  
Spades ace-queen-seven-three, hearts  
king-nine-four, diamonds  
eight-five-two, clubs  
queen-ten-six-three.

IRINIA

Pass.

MIKA

Pass?

IRINIA

Eleven high-card points. Balanced hand. Four spades, not five. Not enough to open in standard methods.

Mika stares at her.

MIKA

Who taught you bridge?

IRINIA

My mom. I'm really good. It's fun!

MIKA

No.

IRINIA

What?

MIKA

Nobody answers that hand with "pass" unless they've actually played. We will talk about this more later. Mikey, keep driving.

IRINIA

Uhhhh .... my boobs hurt. Uhhh!

MIKA

Did you pump? This morning? Did you pump?

IRINIA

Yes! An don't EVER ask that again. Please.

Martin sleeps with hand out window as they drive on.

INT. CLERKS OFFICE

TWO WOMEN at a long table.

The table is old, solid hard wood.

The woman are in the early 50s with stacks of stapled, organized papers in front of them.

They are in a bustling clerks office.

WOMAN 1

Is Hamerlik still with the firm. Roger?

WOMAN 2

No he left.

She looks up and thinks.

WOMAN 2

Four years ago. I thought five but it's definitely four.

WOMAN 1

I liked Roger. He was my son's basketball coach.

WOMAN 2

Absolutely, a great guy. Great guy. You know he got divorced right?

WOMAN 1

Yes, that was while he was coaching.  
(MORE)

WOMAN 1 (CONT'D)

One of the other mom's told me. I think it was the Olsen mother.

WOMAN 2

He met some professor at the University and just decided to move with her. He went somewhere, Louisville, Nashville ... Memphis? Around there.

Woman 1 stands up.

WOMAN 1

Oh yes, a fresh start. Nothing says opportunity like Memphis. OK these ... these are good. I just checked them all. I'm gonna get a cup of coffee. You want anything?

WOMAN 2

Yeah, get me, uh, get me a Snick- no Musketeer. Get me a Three Musketeers.

Woman 1 walks to candy counter with many people flowing through building.

WOMAN 1

Hi Ed, do you have a Three Musketeers? I don't see any. I need one cup of coffee, black.

EDWARD

No we are out.

WOMAN 1

OK ... what else do we have here.

EDWARD

We have a scone. We have scones.

WOMAN 1

Not even remotely like a Three Musketeers. But OK. Whats a Zagnut like?

EDWARD

The scones are good too. They have chocolate chips in them.

WOMAN 1

Great. I'll take the coffee and the Zagnut. Stop trying to push the scones.

EDWARD

No one want these things. This stuff - the vendor - they kept telling me to get them - that they would sell. None, not one. The donuts meanwhile -

WOMAN 1

Ed, one Zagnut, one black coffee. Thanks.

EDWARD

OK, OK. Zagnut, good choice.

WOMAN 1

Thanks. Thank you Ed.

Woman 1 heads back to the table.

She tosses down the Zagnut.

Woman 2 looks stunned.

WOMAN 2

That's not a Three Musketeers.

WOMAN 1

No, it's better. Who is ...

Woman 1's attention is now on the concourse.

She sees Mikey small talking and laughing with guards.

Irinia is putting jewelry into a bin.

Her attention is focused on Mika who is literally helping Martin to the security gate.

She hears one of the Guards.

GUARD 1

Hey I told you once. Don't do that. This is the second warning. Don't do that!

Woman 1 heads over to the metal detector.

WOMAN 2

This is actually better than a Three Musketeers.

Woman 1 is now at the metal detector.

WOMAN 1

Hi - you're - I am going to guess, Irinia? Are you Irinia?

IRINIA

Yes, yes! You are?

WOMAN 1

Cynthia Wald. We spoke on the phone. I work for Schuyler and Farbman. I - we spoke on the phone about the closing. I'm your lawyer. It's great to meet you. Um ... who are all these people?

IRINIA

Oh, that's Mikey - my real estate agent.

CYNTHIA

I know Mikey. Hi Mikey.

IRINIA

And Martin is there. And that's Mika.

CYNTHIA

Who is Mika?

IRINIA

He is the seller. He's selling the house.

CYNTHIA

He doesn't need to be here. In fact -

GUARD 2

OK - listen. Hey! If he can't walk through the metal detector - then you can't help him. Unless he has a wheel chair or something. This ain't no Goddamn marathon finish line.

MIKA

He injured thumb - not feeling the best right now..

GUARD 1

If he vomits, if he falls, if he says a word, he is out of here.

MIKA

No, no, no. He has to close on a house. He hurt his hand last night. If he does not close today the house goes back on the market. Back on the market!



CYNTHIA

Guys, they are here for a closing.  
Not court. I am representing ...  
this. I'll watch him. Any issue,  
you can toss us all. Nothing will  
happen.

GUARD 2

So you know them?

CYNTHIA

Yeah, it will be fine.

GUARD 1

OK. But buddy, you try to use the  
metal detector as a pull up bar  
again and you are out.

MARTIN

I was not. I don't think.

Martin makes it through and Irinia helps him.

GUARD 2

You. You next. Go.

Mika goes through safely.

GUARD 1

Cynthia, any bullshit from these  
guys and they are out. I mean out.  
First one is that guy.

Guard points to Mika.

MIKA

I know. I know. You do your job.  
I understand. No problems, I  
promise.

Cynthia shepherds the group toward the large room with  
many tables.

CYNTHIA

So, maybe someone can explain why we  
have an entire entourage for a  
closing. We just need Irinia and  
... what is his name?

MIKA

Martin. I am Mika.

CYNTHIA

Great, you're the seller right?

MIKA

Yes, is correct.

CYNTHIA

We don't need you here! In fact it would be better if you were not here!

MIKA

Oh no, no, I must be here. Must see it close. I know Mikey, Irinia, I want only the best for everyone.

CYNTHIA

Great, it's not like we are having a baby here. We don't need the whole family.

MARTIN

Baby. I have one. Angela. She's around here somewhere. Angela?

CYNTHIA

Whats wrong with him. He looks -

MIKA

Like he is on another planet. Yes, we know.

IRINIA

His hand. See, he has two jobs. He does tiles. He has his own company. But on off days or half days he finds work. So, he was doing a closet redo. His asshole friend made him laugh when we using the oscillating and saw and ... well .. you see the thumb.

MARTIN

28 holding it together.

MIKA

I did not know a friend caused this? Who is this guy?

CYNTHIA

28 what?

MIKEY

Stitches. Holding the fingernail on. The crazy thing ... the stitch goes RIGHT THROUGH the nail!

Cynthia holds up her hands in a stop motion.

CYNTHIA

I don't need hear another thing. Not one more thing. You have about  
(MORE)

CYNTHIA (CONT'D)  
15 minutes before a table opens up.  
You will be next.

MIKA  
Great!

CYNTHIA  
But you have to sit here. And not  
cause any trouble. None! Is he  
going to be able to sign his name?

MIKA  
Yes, he can do it.

CYNTHIA  
Great. He just needs to be able to  
sign his name. Two things. Three  
things. Have a pulse, be able to  
sign name, and not be raving  
lunatic.

MIKEY  
Good on all points. No issues.

She points to a bench. All sit.

The woman heads back to her table.

WOMAN 1  
Who are they.

CYNTHIA  
It's Mika, Martin, Irinia, and  
Mikey.

WOMAN 1  
Who?

INT. RANGE ROVER

We see Mika and Irinia.

It is early evening and they are riding.

MIKA  
Nona, of course, wants to know how  
is Angela. I do as well.

IRINIA  
She is great! The new room is  
working out really well.

MIKA  
Is it like vision board? Nona says  
it is.

IRINIA

Perfect. Just like the board.  
Martin was off work so ... he was  
still able to paint it and add the  
trim.

MIKA

That is just great! Great.

IRINIA

Oh, Martin wants to know if there  
are any shingles.

MIKA

Yes, why.

IRINIA

One of them blew off. He needs to  
replace it.

MIKA

A roof shingle is not light! This  
thing did not fly far. He should  
find it easily.

IRINIA

Tatum found it first.

MIKA

Enough said. Is in garage.

IRINIA

Where?

MIKA

In the rafters.

The car parks and both exit. They head into a community  
center type building.

MIKA

Now remember, no nonsense. Play  
risky, but controlled.

IRINIA

I know. I know! We beat Earl and  
Harrison all the time.

MIKA

Yeah, they are not best players.  
Look, I could teach someone off  
street the rules of bridge for one  
hour and be able to beat them.  
Besides they are more interested in  
the baby when you come to play.

IRINIA

Oh, tell Samantha I said 'Hi' the next time you are there!

MIKA

Great, great. Yes I will tell her. But now is the time to focus.

They approach a check-in table with a sign giving the rules of the bridge tournament.

IRINIA

Hmmm ... we're going to win \$800 dollars.

TABLE MINDER

Well that's if you win. Names please.

MIKA

It is Mika and Irinia, right there.

TABLE MINDER

OK Mika and Irene -

IRINIA

Irinia - not Irene - Irinia.

TABLE MINDER

I-reen-yah OK. Here is your draw. You start at table 8.

They hear a voice from behind.

It the OLD WOMAN from the library.

She holds a cup of coffee.

OLD WOMAN

Oh, Mika and Irinia. So nice. The Soviet Bloc is here! Wonderful.

As she walks away, a fired up Irinia whips to the table minder.

IRINIA

Who the fuck was that! Hey you, when do we play them.

MIKA

Exactly!